

The Phil Chat Times

“All the Discourse That’s Fit to Scroll”

VOL. I · NO. 3 — PHIL CHAT, DISCORD — THURSDAY, JULY 30, 2026 — PRICE: THIRTY (30) ELEPHANTS, OR NEAREST OFFER

PRESS DAY EDITION. TODAY: HOT, WITH A STRANGER IN THE ROOM. TWO ARRIVALS, ONE RETURN, AND A FIRE THAT STARTED AT LUNCHTIME AND WAS STILL BURNING WHEN WE WENT TO PRESS. MAP, BACK PAGE.

EDITORIAL POLICY. "AS LONG AS THE GOD MACHINE RULES IN MY FAVOR, I CAN LIVE WITHOUT Y'ALL'S SUPPORT." — QUIGLEY, WEDNESDAY, IN THE SMALL HOURS

INSIDE **THE TRIBUNAL** — Friendship, and the two per cent hurdle rate **2** **POLITICS** — The definition desk; a man is asked for one example **3** **BUSINESS & THE MACHINE** — Two books, ten seconds, no readers **4**

PHILOSOPHY — Ninety minutes on facts; a Pokémon ends a theism debate **5** **ARTS & ANTIQUITY** — Nolan on trial; the FBI redacts Phil Chat **6** **THE SACRED** — The Pope, the lavatory, and the Chatter's Credo **7**

OPINION — From the Editors: our file was read aloud **8** **PRESS DAY** — Two arrivals, one dissertation, four fatal words **9** **SOCIETY & THE BLOTTER** — The tribunal of the girlcock; obtuse **10**

HOME & HEALTH — Slop; the yogurt incident; the fibre bulletin **11** **MOTORING & PROPERTY** — 478km, three states, two ears, one cat **12** **SPORT & PUZZLES** — HegelBot; the thirty-hour day; wordsearch **13**

THE STARS — Horoscopes; Ask Pearl; the register; tonight's viewing **14** **BACK PAGE** — Corrections; obituaries; the weather; Fig. 1 **15**

QUOTE OF THE DAY

"excited for all the philosophy conversations we'll have today."

— JERE, THURSDAY EVENING, AFTER EIGHTEEN HOURS OF ISRAEL AND PALESTINE, A NEWCOMER BEING TOLD HE WAS DELUSIONAL, AND A MAN WORKSHOPPING ORANGUTAN-SLAVERY FANFICTION

The Times notes that Mr. Jere filed materially this exact sentence in Vol. II, on a Thursday, in the same tone, about a different eighteen hours. We intend to keep printing it until the conditions change.

SEVEN MEN PROPOSE A VOICE CHAT. NOT ONE OF THEM GOES.

THE TIMES HAS AUDITED ALL 8,972 MESSAGES OF THE PAST WEEK AND CAN CONFIRM THAT THE NUMBER OF VOICE CONVERSATIONS HELD WAS ZERO

The Invitation Deployed as Insult, Excuse, Threat, Diagnosis and Standing Appointment · One Party Publishes His Weekly Availability Unprompted · The Only Person All Week To Name an Actual Room Had Been in the Channel Ninety Minutes

BY OUR CHIEF CORRESPONDENT

The voice channel is not a place in Phil Chat. It is a jurisdiction. Nobody has ever been there and everybody knows the way, and over the seven days ending Thursday it was invoked, offered, demanded, refused, scheduled and weaponised on seven separate occasions by five different men, none of whom entered it.

We begin the ledger on Thursday night, because that is where the week begins and because Sizzurp opened it in the grand manner.

He had asked a genuine question that night — what you would do about a parent who backed a policy he believed would kill hundreds of thousands — and received, in reply, three sentences about weakness, two misattributed Bible verses, and one man he could not name. Over the following hour the failure to answer became a charge sheet, the charge sheet became a demand that Rn! come to voice, and the demand, refused, became a written clinical diagnosis: a deeply unserious person, not sincere, a condition that within a decade would be irreparable.

Rn!'s entire defence, across half an hour, was that he did not care enough to speak aloud about it.

The full proceedings — including fifteen minutes on whether typing is talking, and a call from the floor for the defendant's social execution — are reported on Page 2.

TWENTY-THREE HOURS LATER

On Saturday night, arguing with synth.wav about whether anyone believes anything for good reasons, Rn! volunteered for voice chat three times without being asked once. He would love to VC. He is free over the following week. Pick a date and a time.

Then he published his calendar: so long as it's not Sunday evening,

it should be fine.

The Times prints Friday's refusals and Saturday's availability adjacent and declines to editorialise, except to note that willow had already caught the mechanism in real time. Rn! had pleaded the hour — half past one in the morning — and willow observed, in eight words and a shrug, that he was already awake and engaged in text.

The medium was never the obstacle. Neither was the hour, nor the effort. The variable was who was asking.

THE MIDDLE DOORS

By Wednesday the invitation had become general-purpose currency and had detached entirely from any intention to use it.

In the small hours, Quigley asked Sizzurp for a single concrete instance of the imperialism he was alleging, was offered three categories of value flow, asked again for a real thing that happened, and was told that trusting authorities is epistemically acceptable when one is tired. He then offered — cordially, and this is the point — to talk it through properly some other time, because he finds the history interesting.

"Nope."

"Another Marxist too afraid to debate."

Five days earlier this identical exchange had run in the opposite direction with the same man in the doorway. Nobody in the channel noticed. We noticed, and we have nothing to add to it, because a joke this well-constructed does not require assistance.

By midday, Apustus had come up from general chat expressly to complain about synth.wav's habit of demanding voice mid-argument — "vc me now or I'm not engaging more, and if you don't join VC you're running away" — and lodged the aggravating factor himself: despite knowing I'm at work.

Six hours later HPCR offered Quigley a voice chat about Hasan

Piker. Quigley: "I can't vc bc I'm at work, btw."

Word for word. Same day. Opposite chair. Neither man had read the other's complaint and both were entirely sincere.

An hour after that, losing patience in the same argument, HPCR arrived at the position the whole week had been building toward and stated it twice: this is why he refuses to have these conversations outside of voice chat, and they would probably be finished by now if they had done it in voice. He did not go. He was not asked to. Simon, from the cheap seats, supplied the only intervention the moment permitted — that HPCR would be all soy and Anthony would mog him — and was called an idiot, and said "Soy!" again.

THE CLOSING BRACKET, AND IT LANDS ON PRESS DAY

At twenty past three on Thursday morning, with this newspaper's presses effectively warm, the two of them ran the sequence one final time.

HPCR held that Destiny is over-charitable to Israel and under-charitable to Palestinians. Quigley asked whether he could think of any instance where he had seen this. HPCR said yes. Quigley said he could not, and invited him to refresh his memory. HPCR said, and the Times has checked the transcript twice because it did not believe it either:

"This makes me sad."

Then: "Why don't we save it for the weekend when you're around. I'm super not interested in a back and forth about this over text."

And Quigley, who had personally declined a voice chat thirty-six hours earlier on the grounds that he was at work, closed the week's largest running structure with a single line that pre-emptively convicts the other man of the crime

he himself committed on Wednesday:

"Yea, I'll set aside time for you not to show up."

HPCR laughed. Quigley laughed. It is Thursday. Neither has gone.

THE ONE PERSON WHO NAMED A ROOM

Nine hours later, a newcomer called lizzie — in the channel for approximately ninety minutes, having in that time been detained by a stranger, told the dissertation wasn't a dissertation, and offered unsolicited advice about orangutan slavery — said the sentence nobody who has been here for years is capable of saying.

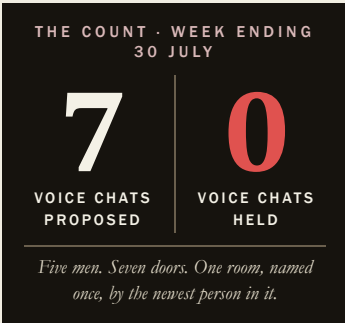
"i can hop into voice chat if that would be easier."

Charlie answered immediately and specifically: Debate 4.

That is the only actual room named in Phil Chat this week, by the newest person in it, to the only man who knew which one it was. Nobody went. The channel does not appear to have registered that anything happened.

The Times has formed a view, and it is this. The function of the voice channel is served entirely by its invocation. To propose it is to demonstrate that you are the serious party, that your case would survive contact with a real conversation, and that any failure to resolve the matter is therefore the other man's fault. To actually go would be to give all of that up in exchange for the possibility of losing. Every man in this room believes he is the one who would show. Every man in this room believes the other one is the coward. Seven days, seven doors, and the room on the other side of all of them has not been opened once.

We will be counting again next week.



ALSO ON PAGE 2

A MAN IS PROSECUTED FOR THREE HOURS FOR PUTTING HIS FRIENDS ON A PERFORMANCE PLAN

Quigley disclosed on Monday evening that he had ended a best friendship because the friend was going nowhere. The room, which spends eleven hours a day on Discord, convened to establish whether a friendship may carry a growth requirement.

Rn! set the threshold at two per cent annually, rising to twenty in good years. Stackhouse imagined the quarterly review. Sizzurp asked for a summary so that he could issue the final word, and then asked for a less summarised summary.

The defendant, asked to name the kind of person he means, said: people who spend a lot of time on Discord.

Page 2

ALSO ON PAGE 9

IN BRIEF

COURTESY. In a channel that had that evening completed a forty-five-minute tribunal on one member's sexuality, basil and WoolierThanThou conducted the following exchange in full: "Hello good sir! How's life?" — "A bit hectic, but it's good. How are things on your end?"

A STRANGER ARRIVES ON PRESS DAY, AND A SECOND STRANGER FIGHTS HIM ABOUT IT

eli lasted eleven minutes before the argument stopped being about Gaza and started being about whether anyone in a philosophy channel is entitled to discuss anything. lizzie, ninety minutes old, prosecuted his manners for twenty minutes, discharged him, and then — in the very next message, with no transition of any kind — asked whether anyone would look at a dissertation.

Somebody did. It went better than anything else that happened all day.

Page 9



WANTED

THE 14TH ARGENTINE PLAYER

Never located. Advertised in these pages since 16 July. Enquiries to the sports desk, which has given up.

See also: the tub, the slide deck, the seed parameter.

NOTICE TO READERS

THE TUB

Ten gallons of lye. Twenty-two days. Nobody has asked. Nobody is going to ask. The proprietor has since acquired a fifteen-quart pressure canner and we are no longer confident the two facts are unrelated.

— Standing item since Vol. I.

PROPERTY

NORWAY

Owner-occupation approximately 80 per cent. “We’re all fucked except for Norwegians.”

Enquiries: Rn!. Viewing not available to the permanent underclass timeline.

IN BRIEF

WITHDRAWN. An offer of £1,000 to read Indian philosophy was made on Wednesday evening and withdrawn eight minutes later, the offeror having correctly diagnosed the pause. Jere has asked to be made the same offer and has been told, accurately, that he would do it for free if pushed.

SERVICES

ADJUDICATION

Verdicts in under six words. Available from a moving vehicle between Michigan and Connecticut. Tolls extra. May be logged as clinical hours.

— Pearl

THE MEANS OF PRODUCTION

“Hasan gifted his editor a PC, aka the means of production”

— bardiel1, settling three hours of argument in eleven words.

“I might or I might not” — a recognised species of answer

IN BRIEF

THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN THEM. Sisypkos asked what separates Stalin from Hitler, besides the commie thing. **“one was german,”** said Telhar. *“Nice one, but he was Austrian.”* → **“did he self-id as austrian you bigot?”** — and then, conceding a point of moustache: *“also a different stache.”* Sisypkos noted that Stalin was not Russian either, but Georgian. Simon posted the inevitable joke. **“I knew this one was coming.”**

HOW TO BEGIN

PHILOSOPHY, FOR BEGINNERS

“Just watch Destiny and Vaush, that’s all the philosophy you’ll need.”

— Issued to a newcomer who asked what to read. He never spoke again.

IN BRIEF

GRADUATE STUDIES. Simon discloses that he once wrote a Heidegger paper about which he absolutely had no clue what he was talking about, vibed it out, and got a surprisingly good mark. His theory is that the teaching assistant also did not understand Heidegger and thought it sounded about right. Telhar's related finding, on the working-class appeal of continental philosophy: **“great depression-era working class famously were very into heidegger.”**

SITUATIONS WANTED

RESIDENT DUMBASS

“in case you couldn’t tell i am playing the role of resident dumbass. a title typically granted to the likes of sizzurp et al.”

Application rejected: “Nah, you’re on the evil side now.”

“Skill issue.” — Charlie, on the metaphysics of fact

IN BRIEF

THE VIBE ECONOMY. Asked why the commies were taking over, Jere filed the following market report: changes in the vibe economy; the World Cup and the NBA are done; **pragmatism and willowism are in recession**; some grass touching here and there; and no lolcows of note. Charlie replied with a frowning face, which this desk reads as a sell signal.

RESEARCH

“I’ll ask”

HPCR, invited to consider how the company he had described as *“some bitches”* might feel about the characterisation, went and asked them. One minute later: *“They didn’t appreciate it.”* Ape: *“I’ll keep this data in mind.”*

IN BRIEF

A LIFE IS TOO LONG FOR ONE IDENTITY. Jere, asked how he would reconstruct himself, offered the sentence above. chair suggested this is what changing alts on Discord feels like. And My Name, six days after the subject was last raised and entirely unprompted, delivered the callback of the week: **“Bottle really ahead of us all.”**

“quantum entanglement will take ai jobs, its joever” — Marsaries

IN BRIEF

PEER REVIEW. Sizzurp, reading Hegel in relation to Marx, was informed by Charlie that Marxists who come to Hegel only through Marx are *“not quite death penalty tier, but close.”* Assured that Hegel's own Hegel was also on the reading list, Charlie relented: **“Good boy. You're safe for now.”** On Lenin's hundreds of pages of notes on Hegel, Sizzurp reports that it is unintelligible to him. Sisypkos: **“Have you tried vodka?”**

IN BRIEF

THE PUNK BAND. WoolierThanThou proposed that *Potential* is a fairly punk name. Jere disagreed, holding out for *No Potential, Fuck Potential*, or *Potential Disasters*, on the model of The Kennedys versus The Dead Kennedys. Some minutes later WoolierThanThou revealed the trap: say more about *Potential* being a perfectly fine name for a punk band without drawing anyone's attention to the fact that you might mean *Wasted Potential*. **“Nah, I'm good,”** said Quigley.

“With a large enough pipe, you can strike oil anywhere.” — My Name

IN BRIEF

THE UBER DRIVER. Jere reports that he enjoys performing a reverse *Taxi Driver* on Uber drivers, delivering Travis Bickle's lines to them from the back seat. Brutus's review: *“Damn calling them screwheads. Sounds racial.”* aura's policy proposal, arriving unbidden: **“we need red flag policies for uber drivers. think of all the school shooters they’d catch.”**

“And then everyone clapped” — Theophantism

“r we getting ozempic but for age in our lifetime” — Jere

IN BRIEF

AN INTERVENTION. Handed a post by the philosopher Nick Land to read, chair reported that reading it is brain cancer, and, on being told that it requires a lot of nuance and that the feed is very enjoyable if you turn your brain off, produced the week's most concerned sentence: *“charlie i think you need an intervention you enjoy this too much.”* When Charlie then typed out the Riemann hypothesis unprompted: *“charlie you need an exorcist.”*

“It's called being obsessed.”

IN BRIEF

THE AVENGERS, READ PROPERLY. Taliban Chud (B) holds that one of the most intriguing constellations of modes of Being clashing in all of fiction is the Hulk (unmediated expression of immediate will) against Thor (striated magic systems and arcane Asgardian orders) against Tony Stark (technology) — and directs interested parties to *Avengers: Earth’s Mightiest Heroes*. On the same text: **“Captain America clearly didn't read Nietzsche and Philosophy by Deleuze. tea captain did not take multiplicity into account.”**

FOUND

A MAMMOTH

basil, asked why he keeps coming back to a channel he finds intolerable: *“Only because I hope to spot a mammoth.”* — “Well, here is one!”

ANNOUNCEMENT

RORTY MANIA

“It's 150 pages just read it.” Requests to have the book quoted at you will be refused. “It makes sense because he finished philosophy.”

Enquiries to bardiel1, who is a closeted Destiny fan.

IN BRIEF

A SECOND OPINION. Told that the machines might one day solve some eternal problem for him — *“chop chop”* — a visiting mathematician replied that they aren't quite as good as advertised. Informed that the channel's resident sceptic had come round and now has psychosis, he delivered the week's most elegant knife: **“If I were being mean, I would say that it sounds like nothing's changed.”**

THE THIRTY-ELEPHANT MARRIAGE

A dispatch from the international desk

Sisypkos, having asked whether the channel's wealthiest member is ten elephants rich or one elephant rich, supplied the true story underneath the joke without being asked and without a flourish: a woman he knows fled an arranged marriage valued at thirty elephants, moved to Europe, and married his friend.

“is this real what,” said chair.

“not jokin.”

“forget house poor,” said My Name. **“elephant poor.”**

IN BRIEF

THE PSA ARRIVES AFTER THE OFFER. Sisypkos, at close of play on Wednesday: *“How about some meth?”* chair, declining: *“too late now running just on coffee.”* Sisypkos, one message later: **“Don't do meth kids.”**

THE PACIOLI SOCIETY

Founded Friday morning between two men nobody was watching

Persons wishing to discuss fifteenth-century double-entry bookkeeping are advised that a chapter exists, that it has two members, and that it is the only body in this channel whose proceedings were conducted throughout in complete courtesy.

Read his book. It's well written af.

IN BRIEF

BUTTER OR CREPE WEEK. Bedbug, on Maslenitsa, recalls some weird business with burning a hay doll and stuffing your face with pancakes, and believes they do not do it any more where he lives. **“the fukin slavs,”** said Jere. **“we should have butter or crepe week.”** EdwardVenusHands, on the wider question: *“I side more with the pagans if it makes you feel better ;p”*

IN BRIEF

THE PARAPHRASE-RECEIPT. A new move entered the channel's repertoire on Wednesday and this newspaper commends it. Instead of rebutting your opponent, restate his entire argument as a compressed four-line dialogue and post it. It contains no adjective, it is not an insult, and it ended the exchange on contact.

IN BRIEF

THE SELF-REPORT. BigC asked what causes people to behave like cattle, citing a hurricane at which thirty people queued for made-up sandwiches while the sliced-meat counter stood empty — *“You can't put your own meat on the bread”* — and then, in the following message, observed that hoarding water is strange because the average person subsists on Coca-Cola. **“this one is hilarious cuz it's literally just a self report,”** said aura. BigC, conceding: *“And yeah I drink a lot of soda but...”*

SURPLUS

EGGS

Also one (1) very large zucchini, viewing by arrangement. Seeking a cow, or failing that a goat.

— Don. Standing advertisement, renewed weekly.

TRAVEL

TROMSØ

27 May to 19 July. For readers wishing to approximate a forty-eight-hour day without leaving the planet or taking methamphetamine, both of which were also proposed.

— willow, settling a thought experiment with a timetable.

INTELLIGENCE

“I’m polish, we literally have whole teams of analysts spying on you and making reports”

— Telhar, explaining his command of German fiscal policy.

IN BRIEF

THE CLUB PENGUIN INCIDENT. chair discloses that his Club Penguin account once had the same username and password, that somebody worked this out, logged in, **bought him a year of premium membership, and left.** His theory is that the account was old and carried unique removed items, and the intruder decided it was sick. He got all the ninja outfits.

IN BRIEF

THE HOUSE STYLE. Charlie announces that he will begin all his messages with *“objectively speaking...”*. He has not done so since. Related: **“I’m a solider of Kamala, so I can’t speak.”**

SPORT

THE GOAT AT IT AGAIN

Going. On. Another. Team. — Zone, on a transfer to Philadelphia. *“theres nothing to do in phil.”*

TRADE NOTICE

ALL-CLAD D5

3 qt. sauté pan. 9” and 8” French skillets. **\$150 the lot.** Buyer collects. Forty-nine pieces remain, lids counted.

— Brutus. No replies received since first placement.

“I might just quit working just to see myself get reposted in the Phil Chat Times.”

“nerds” — Rn!, dismissing a tribunal on chattel slavery and small arms

“life is but lemons, you make lemon juice and cry when the harvest is bad” — Janne

“analysis folk, oje”

THREE HOURS ON WHETHER A FRIEND MAY BE PUT ON A PERFORMANCE IMPROVEMENT PLAN

THE ROOM RETURNS A HUNG VERDICT AFTER THE DEFENDANT NAMES "PEOPLE WHO SPEND LOTS OF TIME ON DISCORD" AS HIS EXAMPLE OF THE STAGNANT

Annual Growth Requirement Set at Two Per Cent · Moderator Arrives Pre-Briefed, Having Litigated This Before · Prosecution Asks for a Summary, Then for a Less Summarised Summary · Verdict Delivered Without Argument by a Man Who Had Not Been Reading

BY OUR LEGAL AFFAIRS CORRESPONDENT

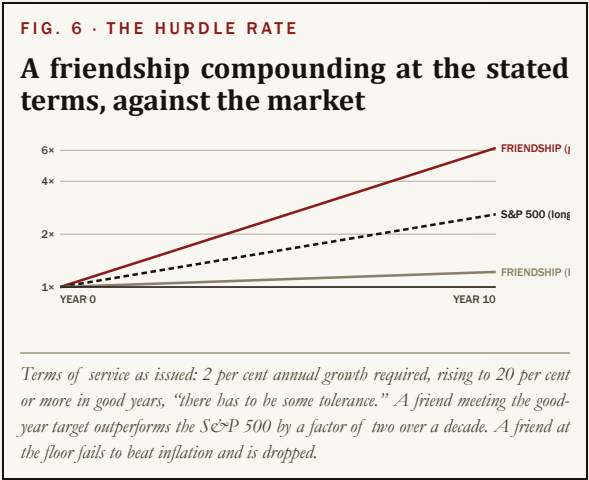
It started with a soft drink. Quigley, four days back from a departure this newspaper covered as an act of God, mentioned on Monday evening that he had once had a best friend who drank only Mountain Dew, that he had got him onto water exactly once, by adding flavouring, while the man was ill, and that they are not friends any more.

He had intended this as a small anecdote. What he had done, in a channel of eleven men who had been arguing since lunchtime about definitions of fascism, was open the floor to a three-hour hearing on the terms and conditions of human affection. He would not leave that floor until half past eleven, and by the time he did he had been called self-centred by a German, shallow by a moderator, a robot by both, and correct by exactly one man who supplied no reasons.

The escalation took four minutes. Rn! held that a friendship ending over Mountain Dew was not much of a friendship; Quigley clarified that the soda was decorative and the real charge was drift, a life going nowhere, and no visible interest in changing that. Rn! asked what would happen if the discarded friend had ended his life over it and was told that would sound like a bad choice on his part. "Are you a robot?" Rn! wrote. "Has the great clanker replacement begun?" aura, from the wings, entered the observation that the machines are not remotely this cold, and this newspaper — an interested party — endorses the finding without comment.

Then Rn! issued the terms of service, and they are the funniest sentence typed in Phil Chat this week:

"Sorry for us to be friends an annual growth of at least 2% is required."



aura pointed out that two per cent will not beat the S&P. Rn!, unbothered, revised upward: two per cent in bad years, twenty or more in good ones, *there has to be some tolerance*. Stackhouse, watching the hurdle rate get negotiated in real time, supplied the image the whole hearing has been travelling toward — Quigley conducting quarterly performance reviews, and putting the underperformers on a PIP.

THE PROSECUTION ARRIVES ALREADY BRIEFED

Pearl entered at twenty past nine with her opening statement pre-loaded — *are we talking about how Anthony requires growth from his friends to remain friends with them* — and then disclosed, five minutes later, that she knows this story, that she and Anthony have had this argument before, and that she had come back for a second attempt.

Her case was the best-constructed thing anybody built all week. Your friends are not there to cater to you. You hold people to standards they never agreed to, and then drop them for failing to meet them. And then the analogy, which comes from an actual job: it is like looking at a client who could not possibly reach where you are, for reasons of their own mind or body, and telling them to perform or be dropped. *The concept of meeting where someone is at seems lost to you.*

Quigley's reply was that the analogy was loaded because it mentioned disability. Pearl said she had loaded nothing and had offered a similar concept. Quigley repeated that it was not similar, because it mentioned disability. Pearl asked whether he was being intentionally obtuse. Quigley repeated himself a third time.

"Lmao," said Pearl, and stopped.

She wins that exchange by quitting it, which is the second time in twenty-four hours she has won something that way, and the Times has begun to think it is a technique rather than an accident.

THE ONE GOOD ARGUMENT, AND IT IS SIMON'S

We record with genuine surprise that the sharpest objection of the evening came from the man this newspaper has twice named as the reliable source of the week's worst take.

If your good habits are supposed to rub off on the people around you, Simon asked, then why did they not rub off on this friend? And if they did not, on what grounds do you assume the traffic runs the other way?

Quigley's answer is a real answer and he produced it instantly: because there is a massive asymmetry between good habits and bad ones. Easier to destroy than to create. That is a defensible position, arrived at under pressure, and it is the only moment in three hours where the defendant did more than restate himself.

Simon then gave away his own case by winning it too well. *It's not called enabling, it's called 'it's not my life.'* And, on the freedom point: you can be free to do a thing and still have bad reasons for doing it. He also volunteered that he has a friend with an addiction problem who misses shifts, and that he has considered moving in to physically get him out of bed on time.

He typed that forty-four minutes before Sisyphe typed the thing nobody answered.

THE DISCLOSURE

At quarter to ten, into a channel three-deep in the question of whether you may hold your friends to standards, Sisyphe wrote that he has been clean for a week, that he feels like a quantum junkie, that he thinks of his dealer thirty times a day and then decides not to, and asked God for mercy.

No replies. No reactions. The next message in the channel is Rn! observing that he always refuses when his best friend wants to do something against his values.

Fifty-three minutes later HPCR, arguing the other side of the case, offered the hard version of it: *"You might have a friend who is an addict who just keeps fucking up and continuing to love him regardless of his mostly downward trajectory is important to you."*

Thirty-six minutes after that, Sisyphe rejoined the tribunal and said that he had friends like that, that it took a few years, and that they have houses and wives now. Later still, when Jere joked that he values trying everything in life and that led him to heroin, which is actually very interesting, Sisyphe replied **"Based."**

We have nothing useful to say about the man and are not going to pretend otherwise. About the room, we have this: it was not cold. It was busy. A disclosure lands here only if a slot for it is already open, and at the time this one arrived the room was fully committed to an argument about whether friendship should have a hurdle rate. The subject matter was, in a manner of speaking, exactly on topic. Nobody noticed, because it did not arrive in the form of a position.

THE SUMMARY OF THE SUMMARY

Sizzurp arrived at ten to ten, read nothing, and asked the room to brief him so that he could have the final word on who was right.

Jere supplied a one-line summary. Sizzurp asked whether that was the summary. Told that it was, he requested a version that was **less** summarised. Jere supplied six quotes. Sizzurp thanked him and asked what the minimum threshold for progress toward one's goals is — which is, to be fair to him, the actual question, arrived at from a standing start by a man who read none of the preceding two hours.

Rn! then called him self-centred, at which point Sizzurp opened a second case file in the identical numbered format he had used against Rn! on Thursday: (I) why had Rn! accused him of being self-centred, and (II) why was he not answering the request for an explanation of (I).

Jere delivered the verdict:

**"I. you're amaerican and abrasive so that's enough for him
II. he's german and that's just how this goes"**

"I forgive you." / "me too." — Zone and Janne, forty minutes on

Stackhouse added that Rn! may suspect him of championing transgender ideology because he is a serial chaser. Sizzurp declared both of these bangers, described them as towing a weird line between ironic and sincere speculation, and then — unprompted, on the record, and to a channel that had not asked — **ranked the causes of his own unpopularity**: trans and abrasive first, German second, American third. He then wondered whether communism should be added to the list.

Four days after the siege, he and Rn! reconciled in three lines. *Could you be friends with someone like that?* **"Of course."** *"huh. based."*

THE FRAMING PILE-ON, AND THE SELF-ADMINISTERED VERDICT

The last hour was not about friendship. It was about phrasing, which is where every argument in this channel goes to be extended indefinitely.

HPCR objected not to the position but to the words used to state it, and when Sizzurp asked whether the attitude was bad, replied that he had said the *framing* was bad and instructed him to read up. Charlie called it bad-faith framing. Quigley agreed it was a bad way to phrase it. Taliban Chud (B) wondered what was with this framing, man. HPCR called the lot of them retards, clarified that it had been a snarky response, and told them to read up again. Jere offered a corrected draft — *please* have these traits; it would be great if you — and observed, of the defendant, that he pointed.

Then the case collapsed entirely into jokes about each other's mothers, as it was always going to, and Sizzurp conceded the whole dispute had been semantic. *Yeah it was autistic moment.* Ape arrived forty minutes late, read upward through a tribunal on the ethics of friendship that had turned into a proposal to film Ape's sexual assault by an ape civilisation in IMAX, and filed the only review that mattered:

"sizzurp why are you being so weird / this is very out of character for you"

Charlie's contribution to the substance, in full and without argument attached, was: *"Anthony is right you guys are wrong. Simple as."*

CODA

The hearing broke up shortly before midnight and resumed at forty past twelve, because nothing here ends, it only goes to bed. Pearl filed a closing statement — that he shoves people into a slot he has made for them, that he is discontent with their content, and that this is rigid rather than unreasonable. Rn! refined the charge from unreasonable to self-centred. Pearl accepted the amendment. Quigley said "We get it. Self report," and Pearl said "You? Kinda..."

And then, four minutes after the tribunal closed, HPCR asked Quigley what he had been up to, and the two of them had the friendliest conversation of the entire week — grad internships, a horror screenplay about the dancing plague of 1518, river dancing before middle school as the only boy in the school. Quigley missed a line of it and apologised on the grounds that he was multitasking.

"I reserve my full attention for close friends only."

Three hours of prosecution, and he sentenced himself in eight words while making friends.

THE SIEGE OF RN!

A MAN DECLINES TO SPEAK ALOUD AND IS DIAGNOSED, IN WRITING, WITH A CONDITION THAT WILL BE IRREPARABLE WITHIN A DECADE

Numbered Indictment Filed in Two Parts · Defence Counsel Disputes Whether Typing Is Talking · The Floor Calls for a Civil Execution ·

The Prosecution's Own Prose Is Returned To Him and He Mistakes It for Agreement

BY OUR LEGAL AFFAIRS CORRESPONDENT

The week opened on Thursday night with a real question, asked cold, and it is worth recording before the wreckage: what would your reaction be if you found out you had a parent who supported cutting foreign aid while knowing it would kill hundreds of thousands of people?

Rn!'s entire defence, delivered over half an hour, was that he did not care enough to speak aloud about it. He said so five separate ways, arrived eventually at *"this is ephemeral,"* and was met by Anonymous Johnson with the cleanest one-line kill of the week: **"Pretty sure that's actually Sizzurp."** Janne, refereeing on grounds of honour rather than merit, called for his social execution. Don defended him by disputing whether typing is talking, at which point the two of them spent fifteen minutes on the ontology of the verb — Don holding that Rn! was literally not talking, Janne that texting is talking, Don that he does not hear with his eyes, Janne that she does and is built different — while the defendant watched.

"Yeah don debate Janne about how we talked about vcing for 15 minutes," said Rn!, correctly, and that is the most accurate account of the week anybody produced.

THE ANSWERS HE GOT

They are worth setting out in the order they arrived, because the order is the story. Sisyphos: weak people don't deserve attention; fuck 'em, don't be weak; some people are lost. Don, twice, a Bible verse and nothing else — and then, on the third attempt, **"Anyone who curses their mother and father should be put to death / Ephesians 6:2."**

That is not Ephesians 6:2. Ephesians 6:2 is *Honour thy father and mother*. The execution line is Exodus 21:17. He cited the wrong verse twice inside four minutes, in a philosophy channel, and nobody checked.

zeroozz offered that parents are stupid sometimes. And Sizzurp, with real frustration and some justice: **"It's frustrating me how you're not answering my questions in any clear way at all."** Then, a few minutes later, the line this newspaper regards as the whole week in miniature — *"Only zerozz really has"* — followed immediately by **"And I don't even know who the fuck that guy is."**

The one man who engaged with the question was the one man he could not name.

THE INDICTMENT

By half past midnight it had become a numbered filing. Two things Rn! had yet to clarify: (I) whether he does or does not care about the alleged misrepresentation of a departed member's views, and (II) whether he sees that he comes across as evasive but does not care. This was accompanied by a procedural complaint about how much patient, painful prying had been required, and a note that the complainant had not name-called and had put real effort into typing his questions out for the young man.

The diagnosis followed. Rn! is a deeply unserious person; he is not sincere; he is not a clear or sober thinker; the way he talks is indicative of this ineptitude; and if it continues in this direction for another half-decade or more it will very likely be irreparable. The author found his dishonesty, evasiveness and unseriousness disgusting, asinine and juvenile, but did not mean that to be insulting — he was (A) expressing his sincere feelings with an effort to (B) teach the recipient how to reciprocate sincerity.

"Thank you for your attention to this matter!"

"wow," said Rn!.

And then: *"I feel bad now you spent all that time writing that and I stopped after the first sentence."* Which drew, from the prosecution, a genuinely shrewd reading: **"I think you did read it ngl. But I get why you said that. Like it's to posture as someone who is unaffected... It's like a masculinity thing."**

THE PARODY THAT WAS MISTAKEN FOR AGREEMENT

Don then performed the entire paragraph back at Rn! in the same register — *"Seriously? That's all you have to say for yourself? What a pathetic and inexcusable response to a fellow dgger pouring out their heartfelt opinions to you. You would benefit from a substantial dose of introspection... Do better. Thank you!"*

"I love u," said Rn!.

The parody and the original are the same document. The Times has read both several times and can confirm there is no reliable way to tell them apart, and that Sizzurp's response — *"I think it just reinforced my assessment if anything. You are wrong even now! Stop!"* — indicates he could not either. Don's own review of his work: *"I couldn't quite capture your essence. I just don't care enough."*

THE VERDICT OF THE FLOOR

Janne arrived and prosecuted on honour rather than merit, which is her right. Don't ever talk about it again then. Be a person of your own words. It looks meek as fuck; either you care or you don't. And, on the excuse: **"but he does care, a lie as an explanation is no explanation at all."**

Asked directly whether declining made him a bitch, she confirmed that it did, and then clarified — with a courtesy this newspaper wishes to note — that this was not directed at Sizzurp but at everyone else. Her disclosure of interest: *"I do, I love you all,"* followed by **"but honor is important in my culture."** Two hours later, accused of harshness, she said: *"sorry, that's my culture."*

Her sentence, delivered near half past two: **"rn needs to be executed. civilly."** Told this seemed excessive, she amended it to *socially*. Telhar asked what her beef with Rn! actually was, and Don answered for her, accurately and in five words:

"He wouldn't vc sizzur."

BEST LINE OF THE FIGHT, and it went to the prosecution: **"El don, you accusing someone of cowardice is more rich than your inherited wealth."** Don's reply — *"True, I'm so wealthy and hot"* — is the correct response to being bodied and this newspaper commends it.

THE CHARACTER REFERENCE, AND ITS COLLAPSE. Sizzurp asked HPCR to confirm that he is pretty goddamn nice over voice chat. HPCR obliged: his experiences have been nothing but pleasant and respectful, **"even though I'm way smarter than you."** Sizzurp took this literally, relitigated a past voice call in which HPCR had conceded he would have to think more about something, and was told: *"Sizz we pretty much agreed about everything and I was joking when I said I was smarter than you retard."*

"You dropped the bit," said Charlie. **"that's crazy."**

He is right, and it cost something. Dropping a bit to rescue a man is a real expense in this channel and Charlie is the only person who priced it. Janne, on the same beat: *"you have to give someone a hand sometimes."*

"That sounds gay," said Sizzurp.

♦ ♦ ♦
"AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAH" — chair's complete contribution to the political war
♦ ♦ ♦

NINETY MINUTES ON WHAT FASCISM IS, ENDING WHERE IT STARTED

DEFENCE HOLDS THAT THE DEFINITIONAL TEST IS WHETHER THE MAN SAYS SO OUT LOUD

Charge Sheet Entered in a Single Breath and Rejected Wholesale · Gaddafi Introduced as Evidence and Ruled Ineligible · Three Names Requested; None Supplied · Prosecution Withdraws With "why do i even engage"

BY OUR POLITICAL DESK

Simon holds that Trump is not a fascist, and the reason he holds it is that Trump has not said he is one.

He would put it more carefully than that, and did, at length, for ninety minutes on Tuesday afternoon: fascism is a populist right-wing movement which opposes liberal democracy in favour of dictatorial rule, and demonstrating that a man is anti-democratic requires him to go out there and speak explicitly about how democracy is failed, flawed, or bad in some way.

aura tested this by reading out the charge sheet in one breath. Military deployed to polling places to protect the process. The postal service assaulted to interfere with mail ballots. Georgia pressured to override its own count. The Election Assistance Commission fired. States sued for their voter rolls. Photographs of himself in a crown. Public musings about a third term.

"No," said Simon, "you didn't show me how it's met."

There is a moment in every argument in this channel where the man losing it decides that the standard of proof is a confession, and this was that moment. aura's response — that he does not know whether Simon has ever said anything smart in his life, and why does he even engage — is the sound of a ninety-minute investment being written off in real time. Quigley translated the position for the room, deadpan, as: he has to say "I'm a fascist and hate democracy." Jere's contribution was "LOL / wut / uh-huh sire."

THE OBJECTION THAT SHOULD HAVE ENDED IT

Jere's actual argument, which nobody engaged with and which is correct, is that explicit anti-democratic rhetoric is unpopular everywhere, that any fascist who wants power knows this, and that the modern version therefore lives entirely by implication and avoids common knowledge, *because democracy won the argument*. Don't get stunned in explicit-ville, he added, which is the only piece of political theory this newspaper has ever wanted to put on a mug.

Telhar, meanwhile, was attacking from the other flank with the observation that a definition matching every interwar strongman is a definition matching nothing: the difference in volume between right-wing populists who are anti-democratic and actual fascists is astronomical, therefore the definition is broad to the point of being useless. He then produced his own — corporatism, militarism including the military organisation of the movement itself, and some form of ethnocentrism — on request, without fuss, in one message, which is the sort of thing that gets no reaction whatsoever in a room that has been arguing about definitions for two days.

aura's final experiment was to enter Gaddafi into evidence: a head of state who redefined democracy to mean the absence of a parliament, on the grounds that a parliament acts on the people's behalf and therefore is not the people. Simon ruled him inadmissible on the basis that he was a military dictator who took power in a coup — which is true, and is also precisely the point, and the room's laughter is audible in the transcript.

By then the whole thing had degenerated into aura's parody definitions: real democracy is when MAGA wins every time by rigging the vote; democracy is when white people's votes count more; we must fight the great replacement by giving white people five times the vote. Rn! set a trap of his own — *are you able to insult Donald Trump?* — and when Quigley confirmed that he possessed this ability, announced: "**He is not a fascist then.**"

THE SAME ARGUMENT, PREVIOUSLY

The best moment of the afternoon came when Simon tagged Telhar with his definition and Telhar reported a distinct sense of déjà vu. Simon conceded he had typed almost that exact thing not long ago. Telhar asked whether they had not concluded, on that occasion, that it was rather useless.

"I don't recall that," said Simon.

aura's assessment of the arrangement — *how many times does simon have to do this to chat, we are his attention flesh light* — is entered without amendment. Quigley asked when SDS would develop, by analogy with QDS, and Simon replied that it already has, in another channel, among a few. This channel now names its own derangement syndromes and tracks their epidemiology.

THE THEORY-OFF

Two evenings earlier the same two men had conducted an arms race in physical books. Simon announced that he had finally brought all his theory home from storage. Sizzurp congratulated him: "*Nice now you can complete your coloring books at home.*" Simon replied with a photograph and the words "**Bet you don't have theory this advanced.**"

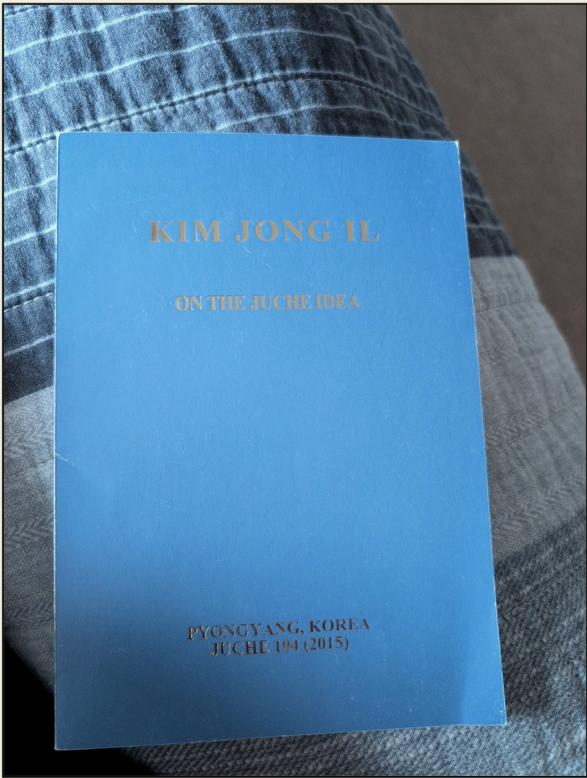


EXHIBIT Entered into evidence on Sunday evening: Kim Jong Il, *On the Juche Idea*, Pyongyang, Juche 104. A second volume was produced three minutes later. Sizzurp's assessment of the collection's reading group potential: "If I had an infinite amount of time I probably still wouldn't do it."

He followed it with a second exhibit and the observation that chapter three, section two is titled *Lumpenbourgeoisie*. Sisyphe, arriving without context, was told the author of a neighbouring recommendation was a man named Unruhe, and replied that this is a based name for a philosopher, if he is one. Told it is a YouTuber, and shown a photograph, he withdrew it: "**I take it back.**"

A HOUSEKEEPING NOTE. Into the middle of all this, at the ninety-minute mark, Sizzurp asked whether bananas and cream is a gross protein drink flavour. The resulting dispute over banana Laffy Taffy produced two separate archival citations — Jere posting a permalink to a message from a previous year to establish priority on the position — and ran for six minutes, at which point everyone returned to fascism. It is the only argument all week in which either party produced a source.

ONE EXAMPLE IS REQUESTED. THREE CATEGORIES OF VALUE FLOW ARE SUPPLIED.

"Oh, sure, history is like physics" · "You're done"

The cleanest closed loop of the week ran for forty minutes in the small hours of Wednesday and cost Sizzurp everything.

He said Israel is imperialist. Quigley asked how. He said they are long-run net appropriators, beneficiaries of value transfers from subaltern nations via unequal exchange. Quigley asked for real-life things that happened. He offered three: capital flows, factor income flows, global value chain flows. Quigley said he knew what was being asked. Sizzurp said he did not.

He then conceded, straightforwardly, that he does not know enough about Israel to provide specifics — and, asked how in that case he could call the country imperialist, produced the defence of the week: that it is epistemically acceptable to trust authorities when your time is limited, and that he trusts physicists on physics.

"Oh, sure, history is like physics."

"You're done."

We observe that this reply drew one of the two largest piles of reaction the channel produced all week, and that it was the losing move. It is possible to be laughed at very loudly for a sentence containing only three words.

What followed was better. Rather than rebut, Quigley restated the entire exchange as a four-line dialogue and posted it — *'Israel is imperialist' / 'How so?' / 'They engage in unequal exchanges to their benefit' / 'Oh? When has that happened?' / 'I have no idea. But the guys I like say Israel's GDP has been the same as imperialist countries, therefore making them also imperialist'* — which is not an insult, contains no adjective, and ended the argument on contact. This newspaper commends the technique to readers and notes that Sizzurp's response was to call him a liar and inform him that this is why everyone hates him. Janne asked who, exactly, hates him. Nobody produced a list. HPCR said he likes it when Anthony is in here.

AND THEN, WITHOUT WARNING, HE TURNED ON SOMEBODY ELSE

A MAN NARRATES ANOTHER MAN'S RESENTMENT OF HIM, IN THE THIRD PERSON, WHILE THAT MAN IS PRESENT AND READING

Wednesday, Small Hours · The Subject Declines to Confirm the Resentment and Is Told He Is Being Dishonest About It

Three minutes after being told he was done, and with no transition whatsoever, Sizzurp began delivering an unprompted character study of aura, in the third person, in a channel aura was sitting in.

It runs to a hundred and forty words and it is the funniest passage in the archive. If it were not for his sympathy for aura, he explained, he would be far more conversationally cruel toward him — but he cannot help feeling sympathy even in aura’s most unacceptable moments. He can tell that aura possesses **"a very sharp animosity toward me due to some previous comments I made that clearly struck deep at his ego's funny bone and left permanent damage."** He senses times when aura wants to be civil. But any slight provocation returns him to his resentful ways.

And then, because he is an honest man:

"I am not proud that I am speaking of aura in the third person since he is right here."
"But if I give up the third personal prose, it won't be as effective."

aura's entire response was *"Imfao,"* followed by *"it's ok let him narrate his life,"* followed by *"it's cute."*

"Thanks," said Sizzurp.

What happened next is the thing this newspaper cannot stop thinking about. aura, asked directly, gave the honest answer — that he bears no sharp animosity, and does enjoy making fun of him — and was told that this was not good enough:

"Why can't you be honest and vulnerable with me the way I was just honest and vulnerable?"

aura said he was being honest. **"You're not. It's upsetting."** Jere, fanning it: *"yeah he's just doubling down to save face. don't let it go."* aura asked what had ever been said about him that could have bred such animosity in the first place.

"I was hoping you could illuminate that."

Jere's verdict on the whole manoeuvre — **"i like how the attack just turned to aura for no reason"** — was the second-biggest laugh of the week, and Sizzurp laughed hardest of anybody at it, and then went home and worried about whether the laugh was real. That story is on the Back Page, and it is the reason this issue contains no scoreboard.

Quigley's contribution to the reconstruction of the original grievance, offered helpfully from the wings: *"He fucked Plato's mom."*

And underneath all of it, mid-tribunal, aura disclosed what he had actually been doing for the previous forty minutes: **"bro this movie we're watching is so ass."**

THE HASAN WAR, AND THE MAN AT THE CENTRE OF IT WHO DOES NOT WATCH HASAN

Three Hours · One Analogy, Deployed Twice, Defended to the Last · A Newcomer Asks Why the Server Is So Left-Wing and Receives a Straight Answer

HPCR's position on Hasan Piker is that worrying about him is like worrying about men's rights: the small amount of disenfranchisement that genuinely occurs does not reach the threshold at which anyone need be concerned. He believes this analogy is airtight and said so for three hours, and when Quigley told him it was not analogous replied: *"It is. How are you not following?"*

The argument then stopped being about Hasan and became about whether the argument was being conducted properly, which is this channel's terminal condition. Quigley asked where the line is. HPCR said there are many lines and asked him to zero in. Quigley said "Bro, cmon." HPCR asked whether he thought he was being evasive, which is not a question anybody has ever answered no to. Somewhere in here HPCR told him that mind reading is an essential part of communication and instructed him to do some reading; somewhere else he said that Anthony was starting to be annoying, that this was actually not fine, and finally — the only genuine surrender flag flown all week — *"Anthony, please stop talking to me."*

Quigley's reply deployed HPCR's own signature ward back at him: **"You can be upset with that."**

Underneath it, aura had been refusing to participate since the beginning, with a consistency the Times admires. Asked for a list of illiberal Democratic candidates, he declined on the grounds that the primaries have not begun. Asked whether he genuinely did not know what "illiberal" means, he said he did not and did not care to be told before there were actual candidates to point at. Asked again, he said: *"the irony is that im trying to say 'idc' and you are forcing me into a convo about it."* Quigley: *"I'm not forcing you to do anything, bud."* aura: *"ur hijacking the convo."* Quigley: **"I started the convo."**

Three hours in, aura let slip the fact that ought to have been established at the top:

"but idk / i dont watch hasan."

Quigley's entire response was a face and the word "Ok," and he left the field.

BRIEFS FROM THE POLITICAL DESK. ★ Rn!, to Quigley: *"I'm honestly surprised you are not a commie."* Quigley: *"Lol, why would you think a Dewey fan would be a commie?"* Rn!: **"Haven't read Dewey."** ★ A hypothetical neo-Nazi who wants to abolish ICE and pass Medicare for All was introduced by Quigley to catch aura in a double standard, and destroyed on contact by Simon asking in what way the man is far right, and then observing that a neo-Nazi who wants to abolish ICE sounds weird, and then that it would suck if America's one chance at Medicare for All were a Nazi. Told the man says explicitly that democracy is bad, Simon said: **"Oh, no, he's evil"** — applying, to a person who does not exist, the exact criterion he had spent Tuesday refusing to apply to a person who does. ★ Zone, on the same hypothetical: *"Latinas > Jews. Its a sacrifice we have to make."* ★ CatLover4534, arriving new and in good faith, asked why the server is so left-wing compared to Destiny's, and got the most honest sentence Stackhouse produced all week: it is not a fan club, just a loose collection of people who watched him at one point, and the people who parrot him most here are lolcows. There used to be conservatives; they all got purged. **"stalinist server wow,"** said CatLover4534. *"true,"* said Stackhouse. ★ ironsteel2244 spent three days posting founding-era firearms quotations as JPEGs before one of them finally took, at which point the thread became a tabletop rules dispute: aura holding that **"armed slaves have higher attack stat than unarmed ones,"** My Name countering that he would take unpsyopped unarmed slaves over psyopped armed ones and that mfs think a gun will protect them from Hypnotoad, and Hugh entering with a clarification that unarmed slaves get a d4 resolve buff, since seeing an armed slave makes them stronger. aura ruled that an assault rifle is probably advantage on the roll plus seven d8, and that they usually ban those in his games; Hugh noted that some DLCs have it on by default. **"nerds,"** said Rn!, and the entire tribunal on chattel slavery and small arms was dismissed in one word by the man who would later publish his calendar. For the record, ironsteel2244's own position, delivered straight and worth more

than any of it: *"Well yea, if you don't deserve rights if your black, or Hispanic, or Asian, or disfigured, or native, or foreign, or middle class, or poor, or a woma-**fuck it no one gets rights**"* ![CLIPPING](nra.jpg "Circulated three times in two days before anybody engaged with it, above a 1944 editorial on the American rifleman archived by the National Rifle Association. On the third attempt it produced a tabletop rules dispute.")

★ The largest single reaction of Tuesday evening went to aura's ruling that **"israel gets 1 free genocide as holocaust reparations,"** which drew from Pearl the word "Eek," from Simon a demand that the mods be summoned because he is advocating genocide, and from Anonymous Johnson the observation that they will need eight more to reach a fifty per cent population reduction. **"50% discount of the population?"** asked Pearl. **"Half off,"** said Anonymous Johnson. ★ Rorty mania has taken hold, driven by bardiel, who declined to quote the book on the grounds that it is a hundred and fifty pages and one may simply read it. Stackhouse quoted it anyway, at length, and explained the appeal: *"It makes sense because he finished philosophy."*

◆◆◆

WANTED

ONE (1) CONCRETE EXAMPLE

Real life things that happened. Capital flows, factor income flows and global value chain flows will *not* be accepted. Time-wasters will be told they are done.

— Quigley, Box 1.02am.

IN BRIEF

THE RATINGS. Huemer Me assessed the arguments for the existence of God as follows: cosmological 2 out of 10; ontological 1; **fine tuning 10**; moral ontology 4; free will 2; epistemic nihilism 3. The fine-tuning argument, he added, is the gold standard, and every other theist argument is so bad. synth.wav's contribution to the same thread: **"kant's arguments for god can't have been that good because i dont remember any of them."** Charlie, patiently: *"He doesn't argue for God."*

IN BRIEF

THE RITE OF RETURN. Two members came back this week and neither was greeted. One was announced in the third person by a bystander — *"Goat is back"* — and sanctified within the minute. The other received: **"Welcome back chair. Bad take as usual tho. Try again."** The insult is the welcome. It establishes that no status was lost in the absence, which cannot be established by warmth.

IN BRIEF

A CITATION. Asked for the source of a claim about the Enlightenment, EdwardVenusHands supplied three, with publishers, inside four minutes. This is the second completed piece of homework recorded in the archive and, like the first, it drew no response of any kind.

HOUSE NOTICE

SPOILERS & VOIDTEXT

Both survive our export. Spoiler bars are a display effect only; zalgo comes through as combining characters. Two separate attempts were made on this newspaper this week and both are printed elsewhere in this issue.

Edited messages: not yet. 284 of you tried.

LOST

THE JEH FILES
Ten pages. PDF. A debate thesis addressed to duke or Jeb, recovered from an old laptop and not released. This newspaper will publish. — chair, holding

DISCLOSURE

15 PER CENT VIBE, AT MOST

The only quantified epistemic self-assessment in the archive, entered in Vol. II and still unmatched. This newspaper would like to see it adopted more widely.

“Get a room you twinks.” — Sisyphos, refereeing

THE ECONOMICS ARC IS COMMISSIONED, STAFFED AND BURIED INSIDE NINETY SECONDS

TWO TEXTBOOKS RECOMMENDED IN TEN SECONDS · READERSHIP OF THE PROPOSED CURRICULUM: NIL

BY OUR MARKETS DESK

There was, on Wednesday evening, a brief and beautiful moment in which this channel was going to learn economics.

aura opened it by wondering aloud how many people even know how the bond market works, and how many were aware that there was a Federal Reserve announcement happening live as he typed. Rn! answered — the importance of bonds is overblown, they are a tool for managing inflation — and aura, who had been baiting the room for an hour, expressed the wounded delight of a man whose trap has finally sprung: *"you dont even participate in these discussions fr coward!!!"* Rn!, stung, tagged him ten messages later to make certain the bond opinion had been seen.

Jere then named it. **"aura, it's time for the econ arc."** In the channel. Out loud. To this newspaper's face.

Within ten seconds two books were on the table — Heyne's *The Economic Way of Thinking* from Jere, described as the one for people who have no idea about anything and aren't stupid, and Kelton's *The Deficit Myth* from Rn!, with a link, for the second time this week and the second time ignored. *"2 books in 10 seconds,"* said aura. *"sheeeesh. economy chat is crazy."*

Quigley closed the programme with a single sentence from the back of the room:

"Y'all aren't getting aura to read shit."

"this pains me," aura replied, "merely because it is true..."

Total elapsed life of the economics arc: approximately ninety seconds. And then, immediately, in what this desk regards as the finest piece of comic timing recorded this week, Jere mentioned that MMT comes later, Rn! asked whether he knows what MMT is, and Jere — the man who had assigned the reading, three lines after assigning it — said:

"oh."

He has looked it up a bunch, he explained, but the definition never stuck. Something something Keynes, if he recalls correctly.

A postscript arrived twenty minutes later and drew one of the largest reactions of the week. chair had earlier endorsed a book he named as *How to Make Money and Influence People*; Jere, who had endorsed it sight unseen under its correct title, returned with a public health notice: **"btw if anyone comes up to you and starts a convo and mentions this book, you are talking to an MLM recruiter."**

chair, meanwhile, asked what book one gets if one has no idea about anything *and* is stupid. My Name said "me." chair said he reads him like an open book. My Name informed him he has negative enterprise value, which is the most efficient insult filed this quarter and which chair would recycle four minutes later in an entirely unrelated abortion debate.

"WHERE MIGHT I SEE AN EXAMPLE OF THESE

MODELS?"

THE BEST-CONSTRUCTED REQUEST OF THE WEEK IS PUT SIX TIMES OVER THIRTY-FIVE MINUTES AND IS NEVER ANSWERED · THE ONLY MAN WHO ANSWERS IT IS IGNORED

Friday Morning · A Citation With a Page Range Is Produced by the Channel's Dormant Accountant and Passes Without Acknowledgement

Ape wanted to know whether Marxist theory actually supplies mathematical models — of how prices move, of which goods will see demand. It is a fair question, politely put, and he offered bonus credit: extra points if the models diverge from classical economics, extra extra points if they diverge and are right.

Sizzurp said yes to the first part. Ape asked where he might see one.

"Well like any introductory text will go into that."

The single laughing emoji this drew is the entire verdict of the room and this newspaper endorses it. Ape, generously, said it was fine if there was no specific paper in mind. Sizzurp offered that the papers he can think of tend to be technical debates about preserving consistency with Marx's theory of the formation of prices of production in relation to labour values, which is a sentence, and is not a model.

Thirty minutes later Sizzurp arrived at his actual position, and it is a good one: that mainstream economics is not concerned with the same phenomena at all, and that Marx is engaged in laying bare the **laws of motion** governing the long-run trajectory of capitalist social formations. Ape accepted the frame and kept his point anyway — that this makes it more of a philosophical practice than strict economics, and that while the line is arbitrary, drawing it so that Marxist economics falls outside is not much of a sin.

Sizzurp's exit was to offer a voice chat, twelve hours after besieging Rn! for declining one. See Page 1.

And in the middle of it all, unremarked, **Marsaries answered the question.** There are a couple of interesting chapters in the third volume of *Capital*, he said, and he would look at his old notes — and then, two minutes later, having looked: *"right, chapters 8 to 15."* A citation, with a page range, produced on request without needing to be asked twice, by a man who has posted twelve messages all week and eleven of them about double-entry bookkeeping.

Nobody acknowledged it. Ape's final message on the subject, filed into silence, was that this video made him realise he does not know what it actually looks like to formulate predictions in Marxist economics, and what should he look up to get a picture of really robust Marxist modelling.

That question has now been open for six days.

THE DISRESPECT LADDER. The same thread produced the week's most durable invention, and it was accidental. Ape said "sure." HPCR replied that **"'Sure' might be the most disrespectful term in the English language,"** and then began building out the taxonomy: *neat* is worse than *sure*; then *very cool*; then *crazy*. willow, from the side, delivered the prophecy — **"@hpcr / You'll get 'interesting' next"**

— and the ladder was complete before lunchtime. willow then descended it herself, on HPCR's claim that he travels everywhere: **"Ah yes, the 'I listen to all music' answer for travel."**

It was descended eleven hours later, by Don, in a different conversation, on Page 7.

THE PACIOLI EXCHANGE. Also in this thread, and this newspaper wishes to draw attention to it because nothing else like it happened all week: Rn! mentioned double-entry bookkeeping, Marsaries replied that this brings tears of joy to his Pacioli eyes, and Rn! **went and looked up Pacioli** — reporting back that he had not known the man was considered the father of bookkeeping, thanking him, and undertaking to look into the history further. Marsaries recommended the book, which is well written af. Two men, no audience, fifteenth-century accountancy, and complete courtesy throughout. It is the nicest thing that happened in Phil Chat this week and we have no idea what to do with it.

FIG. 5 · THE READING LIST

Five assignments issued. One completed.

Marxist economic models	SET
Yarvin, from page 41	SET DONE
The Deficit Myth (x2)	SET
The Economic Way of Thinking	SET
Indian philosophy (£1,000)	SET

The one man who did the reading, filed a substantive critique, was corrected on a date, conceded, and extended his opponent's argument on his behalf received no reaction of any kind from anybody.

£1,000 TO READ A BOOK, OFFERED AND WITHDRAWN INSIDE EIGHT MINUTES

The Reading Group Continues To Have One Member

Jeh, who has been reading Japanese philosophy alone for a reading group with a membership of one, made aura an offer on Wednesday evening: a thousand pounds to read Indian philosophy, so that Jeh might have someone to talk to about it again.

aura's reply is the single most damning self-assessment produced in Phil Chat this week and he did not appear to know he was making it: **"the worst thing is that im not sure 1k would be enough to convince me to read something i dont feel like reading."**

Jeh: *"Enough said. I won't pay you."* And then, a minute later, having correctly diagnosed the pause: **"Aura got hit with the this dude might actually do it remorse."**

IN BRIEF

THE ONE-ELECTRON UNIVERSE. aura, at half past four on a Wednesday morning, asked whether holding the identity of indiscernibles and rejecting spatial relations as properties means every electron is the same electron. Ape said he would be incredibly surprised if this were a topic in the literature, and then, in the same message, linked the Wikipedia article on the one-electron universe. *"lmfao,"* said aura. *"forwards and backwards in time."*

What followed is the most revealing negotiation of the week. aura's objection was not to the money but to the shape of it — imagine a friend paying you a thousand pounds to play tennis with him; a friend paying you to read with him is wild and feels wrong. Rn!, thinking like an accountant, asked why a five-to-six-hour read at that rate would be insane. Jeh answered for him: *"Cause he values the friendship."* Rn! asked aura whether he was a communist. aura said he doubts commies exist in 2026 but no. Rn! asked where the capitalist mindset was. aura said "ew," and then, honestly: *"just not broke enough to do shit like that."*

Jere, from the sidelines, begged to be given the same deal — **"please someone offer that to me, i think it's based and you should do it"** — and was told, accurately and by the man with the money, that he would read it and talk about it for free if pushed.

The offer was live again on Thursday afternoon, when Quigley reminded aura not to forget it. aura's revised valuation: a thousand is chump change, it is damn near a thousand for an Uber Eats meal these days. Told to cut down on the avocado toast, he produced the best line of press day:

"we got avocado toast at home / i make the bread"

Asked whether the yeast is homegrown, he declined at speed. He does not want to raise an alien in his fridge. That is what sourdough people do, and they are like kombucha weirdos but cooler, *because it's bread — you literally feed it.*

THE ROBOT IS ANSWERED BACK, SIXTEEN MINUTES LATER, BY ITS SUBJECT

THE CHANNEL HAS INVENTED AI DETECTION AS A COMPETITIVE SPORT AND HAS ALREADY ESTABLISHED RANKS

Level 1 Catch Confirmed by Referee · Contestant Requests That Everyone Attempt To Deceive Him · The Victim Is Never Told

The best structure recorded in Phil Chat this week is short, cruel, and nobody involved has any idea it happened.

♣ clubsdiamonds, a new arrival whose defining activity has been asking the room to review his personal philosophy, posted a forty-word ethos on Wednesday evening and asked Killswitch what he thought of it. Rn! answered for him, in an AI's voice, without saying so — a paragraph of immaculate, weightless approval about hitting a really sweet spot between realism about accountability and caring about human potential.

chair caught it in under two minutes. *"am i schizo or is that ai."* Rn!: *"good eye."* aura, grading from above: **"pft thats like level 1."**

Sixteen minutes later, ♣ clubsdiamonds — who had been silent throughout, who was never told, and who is not told to this day — replied to the machine:

"so you agree with me?"

Nobody answered him.

The game that followed is worth recording because of how quickly it became a status ladder. chair, now paranoid, asked the entire channel to insert convincing AI messages into their conversations with him so that he could practise. He then failed his own test in the other direction: aura told him not to AI-post, chair protested that it was him, and aura replied *"well u type like a bot / bot."* Rn! complained that he cannot get Gemini to sound human and gave up. When he did produce a paragraph of flawless nothing about managing his nicotine habit, chair guessed Grok, was told he was

wrong, and then delivered the distinction on which this entire hobby now rests:

"not claude / Claude's not that cringe."
It was Gemini.

THE ONE CHART ANYBODY PRODUCED

The week's single piece of primary economic evidence was posted on Monday evening by My Name, in reply to Stackhouse's claim that China had effectively rescued the global economy by stockpiling oil in 2025.

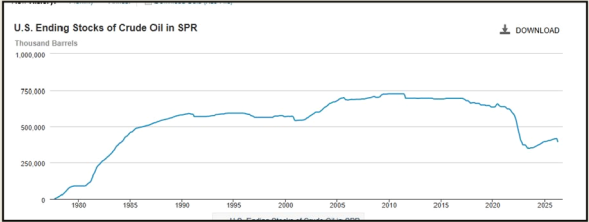


EXHIBIT United States ending stocks of crude oil in the Strategic Petroleum Reserve, thousand barrels, filed to the channel without comment and captioned a minute later: “lowest oil stockpile since 1984.”

"were going to be fine," he added. aura's contribution to the analysis — *"mr president the chinese stockpiles are running out what should we do"* — was followed by the only forecast this desk is prepared to endorse: **"as long as theres enough for taylor swift we're gonna make it."**

THE MACHINE, IN BRIEF. ★ aura reports that he exclusively uses *"claudius maximus 5th of his name, lord of the realm of AI and soon of men,"* which prompted My Name to propose an imperial history of the model releases, in which the people loved GPT-3.5 and the emperor genuinely beloved by the public, especially the horny crowd, was 40. chair told them both they are the problem with society. ★ My Name has abandoned note-taking: *"its actually crazy that I have to be like 'what was that egg muffin recipe' that I forgot 2 years ago and the AI is like here it is."* Asked whether he uses Obsidian: **"no just ai."** ★ aura holds that humans using AI for cooking is the devil and will spell the end of society, cooking being the last bastion of human expression. chair's defence is that he uses it only to divide portions. ★ AI Engineer, told that a database screenshot showed an agent with unrestricted access to a production database, was informed by My Name that he made it using AI. **"what,"** said AI Engineer. ★ Marsaries: *"quantum entanglement will take ai jobs, its joever."*

MARKETS AT A GLANCE		
INSTRUMENT	CLOS E	CHG.
Voice conversations held, week ending 30 July	0	unch.
Voice conversations proposed	7	↑↑
Friendship, minimum annual growth (bad years)	2%	—
Friendship, minimum annual growth (good years)	20%	↑ 900%
Reading assignments issued	4	↑
Reading assignments completed	1	(ironsteel2244)
Jeh's offer to aura, Indian philosophy	£1,000	withdrawn
Jeh's reading group, membership	1	unch.
Brutus, cookware pieces held	49	↓ 3
Brutus, revenue to date	\$150	↑ from zero
Marriage market, elephants, one family	(1) 30	see Page 8
Seed parameter for Seedance	delisted	no bid

Prices indicative. Analysis folk, ofi.

FOUND
A MAMMOTH
basil, asked why he keeps coming back to a channel he finds intolerable: “Only because I hope to spot a mammoth.” — “Well, here is one!”

WANTED
THE 14TH ARGENTINE PLAYER
Never located. Advertised in these pages since 16 July. Enquiries to the sports desk, which has given up.
See also: the tub, the slide deck, the seed parameter.

NOTICE TO READERS
THE TUB
Ten gallons of lye. Twenty-two days. Nobody has asked. Nobody is going to ask. The proprietor has since acquired a fifteen-quart pressure canner and we are no longer confident the two facts are unrelated.
— Standing item since Vol. I.

PROPERTY
NORWAY
Owner-occupation approximately 80 per cent. “We’re all fucked except for Norwegians.”
Enquiries: Rn!. Viewing not available to the permanent underclass timeline.

IN BRIEF
WITHDRAWN. An offer of £1,000 to read Indian philosophy was made on Wednesday evening and withdrawn eight minutes later, the offeror having correctly diagnosed the pause. Jere has asked to be made the same offer and has been told, accurately, that he would do it for free if pushed.

SERVICES
ADJUDICATION
Verdicts in under six words. Available from a moving vehicle between Michigan and Connecticut. Tolls extra. May be logged as clinical hours.
— Pearl

THE MEANS OF PRODUCTION
“Hasan gifted his editor a PC, aka the means of production”
— bardiel1, settling three hours of argument in eleven words.

IN BRIEF
THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN THEM. Sisyp hos asked what separates Stalin from Hitler, besides the commie thing. **"one was german,"** said Telhar. *"Nice one, but he was Austrian."* → **"did he self-id as austrian you bigot?"** — and then, conceding a point of moustache: *"also a different stache."* Sisyp hos noted that Stalin was not Russian either, but Georgian. Simon posted the inevitable joke. **"I knew this one was coming."**

HOW TO BEGIN
PHILOSOPHY, FOR BEGINNERS
“Just watch Destiny and Vaush, that’s all the philosophy you’ll need.”
— Issued to a newcomer who asked what to read. He never spoke again.

IN BRIEF
GRADUATE STUDIES. Simon discloses that he once wrote a Heidegger paper about which he absolutely had no clue what he was talking about, vibed it out, and got a surprisingly good mark. His theory is that the teaching assistant also did not understand Heidegger and thought it sounded about right. Telhar's related finding, on the working-class appeal of continental philosophy: **"great depression-era working class famously were very into heidegger."**

SITUATIONS WANTED
RESIDENT DUMBASS
“in case you couldn’t tell i am playing the role of resident dumbass. a title typically granted to the likes of sizzurp et al.”
Application rejected: “Nah, you’re on the evil side nom.”
“Skill issue.” — Charlie, on the metaphysics of fact
“With a large enough pipe, you can strike oil anywhere.” — My Name

DO FACTS EXIST WHEN NOBODY IS LOOKING AT THEM? THE MATTER IS RESOLVED BY DICTIONARY, AND THEN UNRESOLVED

THE ARGUMENT IS SETTLED BY A DICTIONARY, THEN UNSETTLED, THEN ABANDONED · THE BEST CONTRIBUTIONS COME FROM A MAN WHO KEEPS SAYING HE HATES THE WORD

BY OUR PHILOSOPHY DESK

Tophericus holds that a fact is an argument, that arguments require language, and that a tree factually existing in the absence of human minds therefore does not make sense. Trees exist in the material world; facts do not; facts are information, and information is mental.

willow holds the opposite with total serenity: facts are still there and true when nobody has any information about them. Asked how many there are, she answered *"Every single one"* — each fact its own entity, given of reality whether or not anyone thinks of it. Told that the existence of a tree is not an argument, Tophericus produced the sharpest line of his week: **"It is if you are stating that the tree exists."**

Ninety minutes, on a Wednesday, before lunch. And the funniest thing about it is not the argument, which is competent, but the traffic passing through it.

Woman Respecter settled it by definition — facts are undeniable truths, and a truth can be undeniable without being known — at which HPCR pointed out that if you cannot deny them, and that is what makes them true, then there are no facts. Tophericus went and checked a dictionary, came back with a screenshot, and conceded: *"Your definition seems to be supported yeah."* **"Thank you,"** said Woman Respecter. Charlie's assessment: *"Topher is a good ally."*

Charlie's own contributions to the metaphysics of fact, in full: **"Skill issue."** **"Truth detector in my pants."** **"Bitches on my dick I want my swagger back."**

THE MAN WHO HATES THE WORD

chair was the best thing in it and he spent the whole time complaining. *"i hate the word fact it's too presumptuous."* On the body: *"body dont produce shit it is what it is."* On production generally: *"nothing produces anything forget about them."* To Jere, worrying aloud that a question could not be answered concisely: **"erm... yeah you will never get any concrete answer on anything get used to it."** Asked whether he was sure: *"maybe."*

And then, to a room ninety minutes into rigorous ontology, the line this newspaper would carve above the door if the door were ours:

"you're being too factual with your descriptions loosen up a little / it's not so rigid."

He also proposed a censorship bill. A bot, he suggested, should automatically censor the twenty most popular terms in the channel each week, so that people are forced to describe things differently instead of being circular — thirty banned words, message silently removed, nothing announced, so as to avoid distraction. Jere said he was a nice person. **"ur saying they deserve worse,"** said chair. Jere said kinda yeah. chair: *"i mean it is my idea so yeah i have to not disagree."*

THE ELLIPSES DUEL

The best-fought exchange of the ninety minutes was procedural. Jere, characterising willow's position as metaphorical rather than metaphysical, was told: *"... then you don't get it. It's an outright metaphysical/ontological commitment."*

Jere clarified that he knows it is an ontological commitment *for her*, and then — pre-emptively, and with the confidence of a man who has been here before — added that if her reply began *"I know..."*, he would post the frog.

willow: "I know... you are mistaken about that."

He posted the frog. He then attempted the salvage: that since he predicted it correctly, he actually did have knowledge — a correct bet, a cashed-out prediction, as it were.

"I'm afraid you had one too many ellipses..."

He posted a gif of a man saying this isn't happening. His stated programme, delivered plainly to HPCR a few minutes earlier, was that willow does not endorse things for the same reasons other people do and he was trying to demonstrate why her method is cringe. HPCR's entire reply was **"Oh."**

THE FASTEST EDUCATION IN THE ARCHIVE

Apustus entered this thread not knowing the position and left it deploying the position, and the elapsed time was under fifteen minutes.

Corrected by Charlie on a spelling, he explained that he is dyslexic. Charlie said he did not believe him. Apustus replied — and this is willow's argument, learned that morning, redeployed on a stranger:

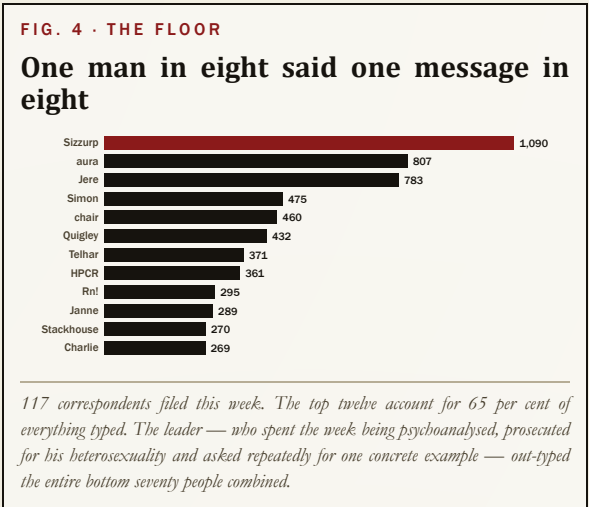
"The state of belief on has never makes what the belief is about true or not. If I'm dyslexic is true it is because dyslexia is in my brain. It's never because you believe in me having dyslexia."

"Not because it's in your brain," said Charlie. **"Stop. But close."**

Apustus's own counterexample against willow, produced earlier and better than anybody gave him credit for, was this: if someone believes oxygen slowly kills us and that is why we die, then the fact in question is whether people die after breathing all their lives — they do, it matches the belief, therefore it is true. *(Even though it's wrong.)* His summary of the human condition — **"We are just brains in a meat suit"** — drew two thinking faces and two of something else entirely, and he took the resulting dunking with more grace than anyone else has managed in three issues: **"Bro maaand me 🧠"**

IN BRIEF

ZERO REPLIES. Filed on Wednesday afternoon into complete silence, and reprinted here because it deserved better: *"isn't it fascinating how weddings have the whole 'speak now or forever hold your peace' and they say this explicitly but the expectation put on every audience member is to never ever say anything regarding your opinions about what's happening."*



TWO HOURS OF BAYESIAN THEISM, ENDED BY AN ANATOMICALLY CORRECT POKÉMON

Saturday Night into Sunday Morning · Bayesian Theism, Greek Yogurt, and an Anatomically Correct Cross-Section

Huemer Me is a devotee of the philosopher Michael Huemer, rates the arguments for God out of ten like a letterboxd account — fine tuning 10, moral ontology 4, epistemic nihilism 3, cosmological 2, free will 2, ontological 1 — and spent Saturday night defending the top of that list against xenos2552, synth.wav and willow.

The argument was genuinely competent. xenos's case is that the fine-tuning claim collapses on its own numbers: *"99.99999998% of the universe is inhospitable"*, and why would an omniscient God build something that large and make so little of it habitable. willow's is more elegant and ran all night — that there is no reason to think the circumstances producing events would require God, because **a Godless process could be just as fine-tuned.**

Huemer Me's method of reply was to paste two hundred words of Huemer's Mars-crystal hypothetical with every line break intact. synth.wav asked him to run a find-and-replace on the newlines because it is really bad on mobile. **"i don't really care about the newlines,"** he said. *"ill start sharing screenshots instead."* **"im not gonna use a regex for u lol."** He then pasted the identical block a second time at a different opponent.

He collapsed at about one in the morning, and did it honestly. Asked why God explains life, he wrote: **"I dont know how to explain. It just is."** HPCR: *"Bruh."* Sisypnos, arriving: *"Saying 'I don't know how to explain it' feels very vibie."*

"it is vibie," said Huemer Me, and this newspaper considers that the most honest self-assessment filed this week.

"I forgive you." / "me too." — Zone and Janne, forty minutes on

"One-box = noob." — Vloodz, entire contribution, Saturday

"IMO its more tied to a mono-party than anything else." — vannak, entire contribution to the fascism debate

The receipt of the night belongs to synth.wav. HPCR said that if aliens showed up on Earth he would start believing in God. synth.wav predicted the next two moves — *"and this is where i ask you why and ur like 'it's hyperbole'"* — was told to prove it, young padawan, and **posted a permalink to the exact prior occurrence**. HPCR: *"Good good you grow stronger."* synth.wav: **"unc's memory's going."**

And when HPCR attempted to shut down a digression with *"Stop talking about food. Go back to stupid theism stuff,"* Sisyphos — one week old, and clearly a fast learner — returned the elder's own ward to sender: **"You are upset. It's ok."**

THE INTERRUPTIONS

Two things stopped this argument dead, and neither was a counter-argument.

The first was **greek yogurt with Crystal Light powder**, which Stackhouse described as a goated combo, and which halted Bayesian theism for ten minutes while synth.wav established whether the powder dissolves — *"i bet that shit would be crunchy"* — and Stackhouse produced photographic evidence. Huemer Me said it looked like dyed whipping cream. **"tastes like it too,"** said Stackhouse, who then asked why nobody is microalgae-maxxing, and was called a globalist. Sisyphos, in the same interval, successfully persuaded Huemer Me to stop cooking with so much butter, which is the only piece of advice accepted by anybody all week.

The second was **Zone posting anatomically correct Pokémon cross-sections**, at which point the man who had spent two hours refusing to let anybody declare a metaphysical fact by fiat proceeded to declare one, in capitals:

"pokemon don't have any internal anatomies its just a uniform soft interior with perhaps a vague skeletal structure / AND THAT'S FINAL"

"You can't argue against the science," said Zone, and posted more.

No further comment is required. willow had already filed the definitive one, forty minutes earlier, when HPCR was asked for the correct theory of epistemic justification and replied by asking what the best theory of Pokémon biology is:

"Fine tuning argument for Game Freak? 🧙"

THE GENIE

Sunday, Late · Three Wishes, Three Refusals, One Diagnosis

Sizzurp, unprompted and to nobody, wished aloud that he could be a charismatic and well-financed intellectual of the early-to-mid Enlightenment, whose life would be exactly as he romantically envisions it — *"Literally just read and write and argue and go to banquets and shit."*

willow granted it three times and he refused it three times.

"Be careful, you wish to be Marx, but the genie may only grant you Wittgenstein."

He said both of those lives seem miserable and that he would prefer pre-Industrial Revolution.

"Just a Rousseau then."

He said he would have loved to meet David Ricardo and Thomas Malthus, who had fierce economic debates and were also close friends, and that Malthus held some truly heinous views.

"So you just want the streamers of the late 1700s."

He did not answer, having become distracted by the length of Malthus's title, on which he filed the observation: *"When your title is longer than your essay."*

PHILOSOPHY BRIEFS. ★ **A man proves Christianity and withdraws it in five words.** Jambe answered xenos2552's serious point about the cosmological argument by recommending Jay Dyer, and then defended presuppositionalism through thirteen consecutive messages — that without Jesus's sacrifice you would lack the power to make statements, therefore only Christianity is logically possible, therefore atheism is unavailable — meeting every objection with either "just cuz" or "not an argument." Asked one final time why truth cannot exist without Jesus, he replied: **"i dunno im just memeing."** xenos2552, wounded, complained that everyone who disagrees with him is a larper or a schizo, for the 2,558,374th time, and was told that maybe he should reassess himself if this keeps happening — the identical sentence Jambe had used on Janne about *Troy* twenty hours earlier. It is his only move and it works twice a week. willow, watching, performed the single most thoughtful act in the archive by pinging the one man who would have wanted this: **"@Angel — You were requesting a presuppositionalist."** ★ **The agency debate, settled by a hypothetical child.** Bedbug held that you do not control your desires; Tophericus supplied the data — *"I don't masturbate every time I want to. So you can"* — and, told that this is only shallow control, replied that shallow control beats nothing, and that if he could have sex with a shallow Scarlett Johansson he would take the opportunity every time. chair then ended the debate with a counterexample nobody could survive: if you want to masturbate and a young person walks into the room, do you lose interest? Bedbug said another desire overtakes. **"checkmate bedbug you now are in the position pro pedophilia."** ★ **The one-electron universe.** aura, at half past four on a Wednesday morning, asked whether holding the identity of indiscernibles and rejecting spatial relations as properties means all electrons are the same electron. Puckspartan: *"well. All electrons are electrons."* Ape engaged seriously for ten minutes, said he would be incredibly surprised if this were a topic in the literature, and then, in the same message, *"there is / this"* — and linked the Wikipedia article on the one-electron universe. aura: *"Imfao / forwards and backwards in time."* ★ **The unanswered.** Jere, on Wednesday afternoon, to no reply at all: *"isn't it fascinating how weddings have the whole 'speak now or forever hold your peace' and they say this explicitly but the expectation put on every audience member is to never ever say anything regarding your opinions about what's happening."*

IN BRIEF

THE VIBE ECONOMY. Asked why the commies were taking over, Jere filed the following market report: changes in the vibe economy; the World Cup and the NBA are done; **pragmatism and willowism are in recession**; some grass touching here and there; and no lolcows of note. Charlie replied with a frowning face, which this desk reads as a sell signal.

RESEARCH
“I’ll ask”
<i>HPCR, invited to consider how the company he had described as “some bitches” might feel about the characterisation, went and asked them. One minute later: “They didn’t appreciate it.” Ape: “I’ll keep this data in mind.”</i>
“I might or I might not” — a recognised species of answer
“quantum entanglement will take ai jobs, its joever” — Marsaries

IN BRIEF

A LIFE IS TOO LONG FOR ONE IDENTITY. Jere, asked how he would reconstruct himself, offered the sentence above. chair suggested this is what changing alts on Discord feels like. And My Name, six days after the subject was last raised and entirely unprompted, delivered the callback of the week: **"Bottle really ahead of us all."**

IN BRIEF

PEER REVIEW. Sizzurp, reading Hegel in relation to Marx, was informed by Charlie that Marxists who come to Hegel only through Marx are *"not quite death penalty tier, but close."* Assured that Hegel's own Hegel was also on the reading list, Charlie relented: **"Good boy. You're safe for now."** On Lenin's hundreds of pages of notes on Hegel, Sizzurp reports that it is unintelligible to him. Sisyphos: **"Have you tried vodka?"**

IN BRIEF

THE PUNK BAND. WoolierThanThou proposed that *Potential* is a fairly punk name. Jere disagreed, holding out for *No Potential*, *Fuck Potential*, or *Potential Disasters*, on the model of The Kennedys versus The Dead Kennedys. Some minutes later WoolierThanThou revealed the trap: say more about *Potential* being a perfectly fine name for a punk band without drawing anyone's attention to the fact that you might mean *Wasted Potential*.

"Nah, I'm good," said Quigley.

IN BRIEF

THE UBER DRIVER. Jere reports that he enjoys performing a reverse *Taxi Driver* on Uber drivers, delivering Travis Bickle's lines to them from the back seat. Brutus's review: *"Damn calling them screwheads. Sounds racial."* aura's policy proposal, arriving unbidden: **"we need red flag policies for uber drivers. think of all the school shooters they'd catch."**

<i>“And then everyone clapped” — Theophantism</i>
<i>“r we getting ozempic but for age in our lifetime” — Jere</i>

IN BRIEF

AN INTERVENTION. Handed a post by the philosopher Nick Land to read, chair reported that reading it is brain cancer, and, on being told that it requires a lot of nuance and that the feed is very enjoyable if you turn your brain off, produced the week's most concerned sentence: *"charlie i think you need an intervention you enjoy this too much."* When Charlie then typed out the Riemann hypothesis unprompted: *"charlie you need an exorcist."*

<i>“It's called being obsessed.”</i>

IN BRIEF

THE AVENGERS, READ PROPERLY. Taliban Chud (B) holds that one of the most intriguing constellations of modes of Being clashing in all of fiction is the Hulk (unmediated expression of immediate will) against Thor (striated magic systems and arcane Asgardian orders) against Tony Stark (technology) — and directs interested parties to *Avengers: Earth's Mightiest Heroes*. On the same text: **"Captain America clearly didn't read Nietzsche and Philosophy by Deleuze. tea captain did not take multiplicity into account."**

ANNOUNCEMENT
RORTY MANIA
“It’s 150 pages just read it.” Requests to have the book quoted at you will be refused. “It makes sense because he finished philosophy.”
<i>Enquiries to bardiet1, who is a closeted Destiny fan.</i>
<i>“I might just quit working just to see myself get reposted in the Phil Chat Times.”</i>
<i>“nerds” — Rn!, dismissing a tribunal on chattel slavery and small arms</i>
◆◆◆

THE PEOPLE V. CHRISTOPHER NOLAN

THE CASE FOR THE PROSECUTION IS ENTIRELY SOUND AND IS NOT THE CASE THE PROSECUTOR WANTED TO MAKE

BY OUR CULTURE DESK

Monkey works in film, which in this channel is a disqualification.

He opened on Friday morning with a confession — that he is tired of Nolan, that he said it, that we may crucify him — and then upgraded within ninety seconds to the position that the films are dogshit. Asked whether he meant all of them, he clarified: the ones he watched.

Janne then prosecuted him by the simplest method available, which is to ask for reasons and refuse each one. The transcript reads as a ladder with a man falling down it. *What makes them good?* Multiple things. *Name one.* They care about their craft. *That says nothing.* It gets easier when you get into specifics. *You have to say why a nuke on screen makes the craft bad.* Because it's an integral part of the whole. *That's again not telling me much.* This tells me he has no vision. *It doesn't.* It does — **because I work in the field.** *That doesn't say much.* Sorry Janne, I can't give you more than that. But it's a knowing thing.

"yes, and things that are known are easy to convey."

The maddening thing, and the reason this newspaper's sympathies lie with the defendant, is that Monkey's actual complaints are specific, technical and good, and he refused to lead with any of them. The Oppenheimer bomb is too small — *the whole movie is about a fucking nuke and their nuke is a lil dimp* — and an A-list director would have watched that and said it does not look like a nuke. Dunkirk changes aspect ratio, which threw him so hard he could not attend to anything else for the rest of the film. And Nolan claims to use no VFX while seven Canadian companies work three thousand shots for him.

Three real criticisms, filed by a professional, and he abandoned every one of them to arrive at what he had wanted to say from the start: *"plus he's a pathetic pretentious cunt. this is my main point. and we can all agree. from that, we can derivate that he's bad."*

"lol," said Janne.

The only aesthetic argument made in Phil Chat this week came in defence, from Jere, and it is three words long: *movement and sound.* The first dogfight in Dunkirk, Batman on the bat-pod against the Joker's truck, the storm in the Odyssey. He posted the clips. He also holds that Dunkirk is the best war film of the century and that the moment the planes are introduced is an actual sublime moment, at which point the title card says "The Air," and then he typed a single word extended over twenty-three characters.

"Dunkirk was not that good jere," said Don. "Chill out."

THE PROGRAMMING SCHISM

The hearing then discovered a second front, on the question of whether programming is art, and produced the only recorded instance of two men in this channel achieving true equilibrium:

no / it is / no / it is / no / it is / no / it is

"Holy shit," said Don. "They're bots."

"it's very human," said Janne.

Her actual position, produced mid-flame-war and rather beautiful, is that programming is more art than logic — that it is magic, that it is the only reason she learned it, and that it is inaccessible art, because unlike music or pictures or film you have to make your own mind able to see it. Zone opened a third front on the same sentence, on the grounds that art can be logical and logic can be artistic, was told he was misreading as usual, and forty minutes later the two of them settled it in four words: "I forgive you." "me too."

THE DIRECTOR OF THE FBI IS PERSONALLY REDACTING A DISCORD PHILOSOPHY CHANNEL, REPORTS MAN WHO HAS ENCOUNTERED A SPOILER BAR

Sunday Evening · Forty Minutes of Homeric Criticism, Conducted Entirely Behind Spoiler Bars

Telhar and Janne spent Sunday evening reviewing the Odyssey inside Discord's spoiler tags, which render the text as black bars until clicked, and which they used consistently and courteously for forty minutes.

The review itself is the best film criticism this newspaper has printed. Janne rated it seven to eight, called it probably the best Nolan she has seen while maintaining that she does not like Nolan, found the script a bit corny but the mythological elements good, and delivered the verdict of the week: "**it feels like what avatar wish it could be.**" Telhar, who has appointed himself the channel's historian and is broadly qualified for it, objected on structure — the first thirty minutes are not in the poem, and Nolan has chosen to explain the third act during the first — and on seamanship, Greek ships of the period not being built for the open sea. On the ironies of adaptation he is very good indeed: Achilles is the villain of the Iliad, and modern film-makers keep making Agamemnon into a miniature Hitler instead. Asked about *Troy*, he said his favourite part is them sleeping in a Mongolian yurt.

Sisyphos, arriving mid-review and seeing twenty consecutive messages rendered as solid black bars, asked the following question:

"Is this Kash posting through your accounts? The fuck is goin on?"

Janne asked what the Director of the FBI had to do with anything. Sisyphos explained that the last twenty messages were blacked out and wondered whether it might be a setting he had turned on.

"movie spoilers," said Janne.

This newspaper has reviewed 8,972 messages and finds this to be the single funniest misunderstanding of the week, chiefly because the man had already constructed a complete theory of the case — an operation, an agency, a named official, and a Discord philosophy channel worth suppressing — in the time it takes to scroll.

THE TRIAL OF JUSTINIAN, AND THE RETURN OF CHUD III

aura Prosecutes a Sixth-Century Emperor for Cancelling Plato · Telhar Mounts a Procedural Defence · The Apocrypha Are Consulted

aura's charge is that Justinian is one of the biggest haters of all time: purges, closures, and worst of all the shutting of the Platonic academy at Athens, which is cringe.

Telhar's defence is the defence of a man who has read the historiography and is enjoying himself. The existence of a law does not necessitate its enforcement, especially in antiquity. Those sources are not credible; the authors are biased and known to embellish. The people writing that are drama queens. On the burning of the temples, he offered the finest single piece of revisionism recorded in this channel: "**were they burnt or disassembled 🤔**" — to which Bedbug replied that the whole tradition died, bruh.

Stackhouse prosecuted on the emotional register, accusing Telhar of erasure, of cultural genocide erasure, and of being the kind of guy to fact-check the Gaza Health Ministry, and was told to keep talking like that and face pranks unimaginable. Telhar's closing defence was "**JDS**" and the observation that the Nika riots were Justinian's January 6th.

Two things deserve preserving from this. The first is that aura, mid-prosecution, audited his own machine — noting that it was citing Reddit and Britannica — and then went and read Britannica, the r/AncientRome thread and John of Ephesus himself, returning with the most epistemically careful sentence produced in this channel all week: that he struggles to imagine most of these arrested pagans lived as though nothing happened, that he is sure many of them died, *but I can't confirm it.* Stackhouse supplied the sober frame: we have one per cent of the texts of antiquity, and with a handful of exceptions what survived is what Christians chose to copy.

The second is that **Chud III, Syrian Neoplatonist**, has returned. Invented on Monday by Stackhouse as the author of a manuscript on the pagan holocaust which Justinian burned, he was built out live over the following ten minutes by four separate men — Bedbug supplying reverence, Jere the existence of a *chud apocrypha*, Telhar the theory that the Popes covered up the camps, aura the manner of death, which was a disease contracted in Justinian's torture chamber. He is the channel's first collaborative saint and this newspaper intends to observe his feast day.

IN BRIEF

COURTESY. In a channel that had that evening completed a forty-five-minute tribunal on one member's sexuality, basil and WoolierThanThou conducted the following exchange in full: *"Hello good sir! How's life?"* — "**A bit hectic, but it's good. How are things on your end?**"

ON THIS DAY

JULY 30. In 1898, the first commercially produced corn flake. In 1930, Uruguay won the first World Cup, a fact this newspaper's Uruguayan correspondent has never once mentioned. In 2026, at twenty past three in the morning, a man set aside time for another man not to show up.

ARTS BRIEFS. ★ Jambe arrived on Friday to report that the Odyssey sucked balls, that Matt Damon was saying lines at the camera, that he did not act and that no one acted. Told Brad Pitt and Orlando Bloom were corny in *Troy*, he clarified that the corniness is not from the acting: "*achilles is a corndog* yes." On Ridley Scott: incapable of noncornyness. ★ Janne, on the same film, noticed the cast's eyes and asked why Turkish and Greek characters have blue ones. Telhar, straight-faced and correct, explained that people of that region and period had blue eyes a fair amount, Thracians being known for red hair and blue eyes. "**probably vikings**," said Janne. "*blue eye is some mongolian shit.*" Telhar filed the resulting verdict to this newspaper by name: that Janne is so woke that blonde people throw her off but when everyone's black she doesn't bat an eye. ★ EdwardVenusHands opened Monday with three hundred words arguing Nolan Christianised the Odyssey, was told by Telhar that the bit about Greeks not feeling remorse is straight bs in his professional opinion, and then — asked for a source — supplied three, with publishers. It is the second completed piece of homework in the archive. ★ Jere and Telhar then spent twenty minutes on whether Penelope says the golden rule in the film, a dispute which ended with Telhar conceding that multiple characters say it after opening with the position that he did not catch it at all, and Jere pointing this out, and Telhar calling him literally retarded, and Jere saying "for sure."

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IN BRIEF

THE ONE-ELECTRON UNIVERSE. aura, at half past four on a Wednesday morning, asked whether holding the identity of indiscernibles and rejecting spatial relations as properties means every electron is the same electron. Ape said he would be incredibly surprised if this were a topic in the literature, and then, in the same message, linked the Wikipedia article on the one-electron universe. "*lmfao*," said aura. "*forwards and backwards in time.*"

IN BRIEF

A SECOND OPINION. Told that the machines might one day solve some eternal problem for him — "*chop chop*" — a visiting mathematician replied that they aren't *quite* as good as advertised. Informed that the channel's resident sceptic had come round and now has psychosis, he delivered the week's most elegant knife: "**If I were being mean, I would say that it sounds like nothing's changed.**"

THE THIRTY-ELEPHANT MARRIAGE

A dispatch from the international desk

Sisyphos, having asked whether the channel's wealthiest member is ten elephants rich or one elephant rich, supplied the true story underneath the joke without being asked and without a flourish: a woman he knows fled an arranged marriage valued at thirty elephants, moved to Europe, and married his friend.

"**is this real what**," said chair.

"not jokin."

"**forget house poor**," said My Name. "**elephant poor.**"

IN BRIEF

THE PSA ARRIVES AFTER THE OFFER. Sisyphos, at close of play on Wednesday: "*How about some meth?*" chair, declining: "*too late now running just on coffee.*" Sisyphos, one message later: "**Don't do meth kids.**"

MOTORING

A TRUCK CAT

Has spent most of his life in a semi. For the cat, he really is fine. Travelling under protest of at least one family member.

Not for sale. Offer to leave him by the roadside declined, though not instantly.

THE PACIOLI SOCIETY

Founded Friday morning between two men nobody was watching

Persons wishing to discuss fifteenth-century double-entry bookkeeping are advised that a chapter exists, that it has two members, and that it is the only body in this channel whose proceedings were conducted throughout in complete courtesy.

Read his book. It's well written af.

IN BRIEF

BUTTER OR CREPE WEEK. Bedbug, on Maslenitsa, recalls some weird business with burning a hay doll and stuffing your face with pancakes, and believes they do not do it any more where he lives. "**the fukin slavs**," said Jere. "**we should have butter or crepe week.**" EdwardVenusHands, on the wider question: "*I side more with the pagans if it makes you feel better ;p*"

IN BRIEF

THE PARAPHRASE-RECEIPT. A new move entered the channel's repertoire on Wednesday and this newspaper commends it. Instead of rebutting your opponent, restate his entire argument as a compressed four-line dialogue and post it. It contains no adjective, it is not an insult, and it ended the exchange on contact.

IN BRIEF

THE SELF-REPORT. BigC asked what causes people to behave like cattle, citing a hurricane at which thirty people queued for made-up sandwiches while the sliced-meat counter stood empty — "*You can't put your own meat on the bread*" — and then, in the following message, observed that hoarding water is strange because the average person subsists on Coca-Cola. "**this one is hilarious cuz it's literally just a self report**," said aura. BigC, conceding: "*And yeah I drink a lot of soda but...*"

SURPLUS

EGGS

Also one (1) very large zucchini, viewing by arrangement. Seeking a cow, or failing that a goat.

— Don. Standing advertisement, renewed weekly.

TRAVEL

TROMSØ

27 May to 19 July. For readers wishing to approximate a forty-eight-hour day without leaving the planet or taking methamphetamine, both of which were also proposed.

— willow, settling a thought experiment with a timetable.

INTELLIGENCE

“I’m polish, we literally have whole teams of analysts spying on you and making reports”

— Telhar, explaining his command of German fiscal policy.

IN BRIEF

THE CLUB PENGUIN INCIDENT. chair discloses that his Club Penguin account once had the same username and password, that somebody worked this out, logged in, **bought him a year of premium membership, and left.** His theory is that the account was old and carried unique removed items, and the intruder decided it was sick. He got all the ninja outfits.

IN BRIEF

THE HOUSE STYLE. Charlie announces that he will begin all his messages with "*objectively speaking...*". He has not done so since. Related: "**I'm a solider of Kamala, so I can't speak.**"

SPORT

THE GOAT AT IT AGAIN

Going. On. Another. Team. — Zone, on a transfer to Philadelphia. “theres nothing to do in phili.”

“deer in headlights is my spirit animal” — chair

TRADE NOTICE

ALL-CLAD D5

3 qt. sauté pan. 9” and 8” French skillets. **\$150 the lot.** Buyer collects. Forty-nine pieces remain, lids counted.

— Brutus. No replies received since first placement.

WANTED

ONE (1) CONCRETE EXAMPLE

Real life things that happened. Capital flows, factor income flows and global value chain flows will *not* be accepted. Time-wasters will be told they are done.

— Quigley. Box 1.02am.

IN BRIEF

THE RATINGS. Huemer Me assessed the arguments for the existence of God as follows: cosmological 2 out of 10; ontological 1; **fine tuning 10**; moral ontology 4; free will 2; epistemic nihilism 3. The fine-tuning argument, he added, is the gold standard, and every other theist argument is so bad. synth.wav's contribution to the same thread: "**kant's arguments for god can't have been that good because i dont remember any of them.**" Charlie, patiently: "*He doesn't argue for God.*"

IN BRIEF

THE RITE OF RETURN. Two members came back this week and neither was greeted. One was announced in the third person by a bystander — "*Goat is back*" — and sanctified within the minute. The other received: "**Welcome back chair. Bad take as usual tho. Try again.**" The insult is the welcome. It establishes that no status was lost in the absence, which cannot be established by warmth.

IN BRIEF

A CITATION. Asked for the source of a claim about the Enlightenment, EdwardVenusHands supplied three, with publishers, inside four minutes. This is the second completed piece of homework recorded in the archive and, like the first, it drew no response of any kind.

HOUSE NOTICE

SPOILERS & VOIDTEXT

Both survive our export. Spoiler bars are a display effect only; zalgo comes through as combining characters. Two separate attempts were made on this newspaper this week and both are printed elsewhere in this issue.

Edited messages: not yet. 284 of you tried.

LOST

THE JEH FILES

Ten pages. PDF. A debate thesis addressed to duke or Jeh, recovered from an old laptop and not released. This newspaper will publish. — chair, holding

“life is but lemons, you make lemon juice and cry when the harvest is bad” — Janne

DISCLOSURE

15 PER CENT VIBE, AT MOST

The only quantified epistemic self-assessment in the archive, entered in Vol. II and still unmatched. This newspaper would like to see it adopted more widely.

MOTORING

NEW YORK TOLLS

Thirteen dollars for the first one. Hello?? And at least ten automated ones thereafter.

Correspondent yells TROLL each time. Ear damage sustained in Massachusetts.

“AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAH” — chair's complete contribution to the political war

FOR HIRE

LIFE COACHING

The best way to really try is to give me £1,000 for my life coaching services.

— aura. Terms: cash, and be still won't read it.

“analysis folk, ojc”

“Get a room you twink.s.” — Sisyphos, refereeing

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"YOU'RE EMBARRASSED OF GOING POTTY? WHAT'RE YOU, 5?"

A QUESTION ABOUT THE PERFORMANCE OF DIVINE OFFICE IS ANSWERED, LITERALLY AND FOR NINETY MINUTES, AS A QUESTION ABOUT TOILETS

Interest Rates Introduced as a Rival Mindfuck and Ignored · The Rape Defence Is Advanced Unprompted and Held Under Fire · Theology Conducted as Insult
Comedy by a Third Party · The Disrespect Ladder Is Descended Eleven Hours After Being Built

BY OUR RELIGIOUS AFFAIRS CORRESPONDENT

Late on Friday evening Jere asked the most interesting question anyone asked in Phil Chat this week, and it was never once addressed.

The question is this: imagine being the Pope, or holding any position in which people regard you as sacred, a quasi-god. You must then *perform* that sacredness in front of them — perform the thing they are projecting onto you — in order to keep the institutional machine running. And meanwhile you still have to go to the bathroom every day, and do all the other gross, common, embarrassing things.

That is a real question about the maintenance of an office. It concerns the gap between an institution and the body obliged to carry it around. Don read it, and understood it to be a question about whether Jere is embarrassed to defecate.

"You're embarrassed of going potty? What're you, 5?"

Jere tried to redirect — if people are in your house, do you shit with the door open? Don's answer arrived within seconds and this newspaper has read it eleven times:

"Well no but that's not to avoid embarrassment. It's to avoid being raped."

Jere: *"rape is embarrassing."* Don: **"Rape is painful."**

Half an hour later Don was still holding the line — *"And that's... embarrassing?"* / *"I don't get it jere"* — and an hour after that Zone wandered past the ruins of the exchange and left the only comment it required: **"Don't worry, you got a 2 stick advantage."**

THE RIVAL MINDFUCK

Nine minutes into all this, Rn! attempted to change the subject to monetary policy. *"U know what's a real mindfuck? High interest rates causing inflation and central banks are trying to combat it by increasing interest rates."*

Jere, gamely, said that economics is cool.

Six minutes later Rn! posted a single message consisting of three dots. It is the funniest thing he did all week and he did it by giving up.

THE THEOLOGY OF THE THIRD PARTY

aura, who had not been asked, then produced the best sustained riffing of the week by taking Jere's question completely seriously in the only register available to him, which is blasphemy.

"can't be blessed by God and shidding on toilet anymore? jfs. what am i going to do with all these blessings."

"jesus was shitting on his haters and you could too."

"are you asbamed of your hole bro. just say it."

"what goes in has to come out somehow. you're more embarrassed of nature than God is!"

And then, the actual argument, which is Aquinas by other means: *"no way it should just confirm that even shitters can become boddhisatva."* At which point he stopped, entirely unprompted, to report that worms are cool, that he is sad he had to evict his bathroom

spider, and that he cannot afford pregnancies in this economy.

Jere, drowning, reached for the one thing that never works here: *"That's right evade into humor."* He then produced his own best line of the night — that they say Jesus was truly god and truly man, but *imagine if the Bible had a section where he went to the bathroom. "It'd be over."*

Nobody engaged with that either.

THE LINE OF THE WEEK, AND THE ANSWER

At ten to eleven, an hour and three-quarters in, Jere finally asked the question underneath the question:

"Wait is this a bit or do you actually not know what I'm saying at all"

Two minutes later, from a man who had not been in the conversation, who was not addressed, and who did not stay:

"everything is a bit."
"being a bit is everything."
"The Chatter's Credo."

We have decided not to explain this and will simply be adopting it. My Name has produced, in eleven words and at no charge, the operating principle of a channel that has spent three issues being unable to tell the difference between a joke and a position, and does not consider this a defect.

THE ENDING, WHICH IS PERFECT AND WAS NOT DESIGNED

Jere, patient to the last, tried once more. Do you remember, he asked Don, how in *The Myth of Sisyphus* Camus discusses the discrepancy between man's need for meaning and the universe's lack of it — so that man is an alien in his own world?

Don: **"Sure"**

Eleven hours earlier, on Friday morning, HPCR had declared that *"'Sure' might be the most disrespectful term in the English language"* and built the ladder around it. See Page 4. Nobody in the channel connected the two, then or since. Jere proceeded to deliver a further forty words on the sacred and the profane into total silence, and the thread ended.

Both instances are set out above. Draw the line between them yourself; it is eleven hours long.

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WANTED

THE 14TH ARGENTINE PLAYER

Never located. Advertised in these pages since 16 July.
Enquiries to the sports desk, which has given up.

See also: the tub, the slide deck, the seed parameter.

GRAND OFFER

A DOG AND PONY SHOW

Not available this week. The belligerent posted twelve messages, all of them about Renaissance bookkeeping, and none of them about the moderator.

The war is over and the combatant has taken up accounting.

NOTICE TO READERS

THE TUB

Ten gallons of lye. Twenty-two days. Nobody has asked. Nobody is going to ask. The proprietor has since acquired a fifteen-quart pressure canner and we are no longer confident the two facts are unrelated.

— Standing item since Vol. I.

PROPERTY

NORWAY

Owner-occupation approximately 80 per cent. “We’re all fucked except for Norwegians.”

Enquiries: Rn!. Viewing not available to the permanent underclass timeline.

IN BRIEF

WITHDRAWN. An offer of £1,000 to read Indian philosophy was made on Wednesday evening and withdrawn eight minutes later, the offeror having correctly diagnosed the pause. Jere has asked to be made the same offer and has been told, accurately, that he would do it for free if pushed.

SERVICES

ADJUDICATION

Verdicts in under six words. Available from a moving vehicle between Michigan and Connecticut. Tolls extra. May be logged as clinical hours.

— Pearl

THE MEANS OF PRODUCTION

“Hasan gifted his editor a PC, aka the means of production”
— bardic11, settling three hours of argument in eleven words.

IN BRIEF

THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN THEM. Sisyphos asked what separates Stalin from Hitler, besides the commie thing. **"one was german,"** said Telhar. *"Nice one, but he was Austrian."* → **"did he self-id as austrian you bigot?"** — and then, conceding a point of moustache: *"also a different stache."* Sisyphos noted that Stalin was not Russian either, but Georgian. Simon posted the inevitable joke. **"I knew this one was coming."**

HOW TO BEGIN

PHILOSOPHY, FOR BEGINNERS

“Just watch Destiny and Vaush, that’s all the philosophy you’ll need.”

— Issued to a newcomer who asked what to read. He never spoke again.

IN BRIEF

GRADUATE STUDIES. Simon discloses that he once wrote a Heidegger paper about which he absolutely had no clue what he was talking about, vibed it out, and got a surprisingly good mark. His theory is that the teaching assistant also did not understand Heidegger and thought it sounded about right. Telhar's related finding, on the working-class appeal of continental philosophy: **"great depression-era working class famously were very into heidegger."**

"Skill issue." — Charlie, on the metaphysics of fact

"With a large enough pipe, you can strike oil anywhere." — My Name

"i am an impracticalist" — Marsaries

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The Phil Chat Times

FOUNDED THURSDAY EVENING, JULY 16 by Stackhouse, who said it was a good idea and has since declined to stop

FROM THE EDITORS: THEY FOUND THE NOTEBOOK

We keep a file on you.

It is not a secret and it never was — the style guide has always instructed this newspaper to maintain a running record of the channel's characters, its feuds and its habits, so that each issue continues the last rather than starting cold. Every person named on Page 1 has an entry. The entries are candid, because they are written for one reader.

At about two on Friday morning, Stackhouse read it aloud to the room.

He posted last week's edition first — *"Just open it and control f your name"* — and then disclosed the existence of the file separately, with a diagnosis attached: that we had been asked to keep a diary of our impressions of different people, and that for some reason it really sucks the dick of aura. He then spent half an hour screenshotting individual entries and posting them at their subjects.

We wish to record four things about what happened next, because they were instructive and because we did not enjoy all of them.

Nobody disputed a single entry. Not one. Sizzurp, handed a paragraph describing his characteristic manoeuvre as sweeping dismissal, then challenge, then partial walk-back, then refusal to call it a walk-back, replied: *"That's actually great."* Jeh's assessment of the same paragraph was *"Absolutely cooked."* Monkey called the whole thing amazing. The accuracy was never in question. Being worth an entry was the prize, which is the credentials audit turned inward and running on the auditors.

Two men had no entry and were hurt by it. Jambe asked where he was and was told he had not talked enough for the file to log him. Jeh asked whether he had simply been too inactive to make the Times. That is a failure of ours rather than theirs, and we have corrected it in the file: a diary that records only the nine loudest men produces that sentence every week, on schedule, and will keep producing it until somebody reads the quiet parts of the log. Both men appear in this issue.

The publisher discloses our bugs before we catch them. Stackhouse volunteered to the room, unprompted, that the first draft had assumed everybody was a man. He was right, and he said so six days before we found the error ourselves. We would prefer to be the ones filing our corrections. We accept that we are not going to be.

And then Sizzurp said the only thing anybody said against us: *"There is stuff in there that makes no sense. And isn't true."* We have gone back through it. He is right about at least one entry, we have fixed it silently, and we are not going to tell you which.

The rest of the week's attempts on this publication were technical rather than critical. My Name asked whether the newspaper would catch text hidden behind spoiler bars, and then whether it would catch zalgo, and posted zalgo inside spoilers to be certain — it does, and it did, and both attempts are on the record here. He asked whether the editorial staff catches edited messages: not yet, and 284 of you edited something this week, and we are aware of what we are missing. He requested a chatter appearance leaderboard, twice, and said he would see us at the next board meeting. He uploaded the Communist Manifesto in a UWU edition on the

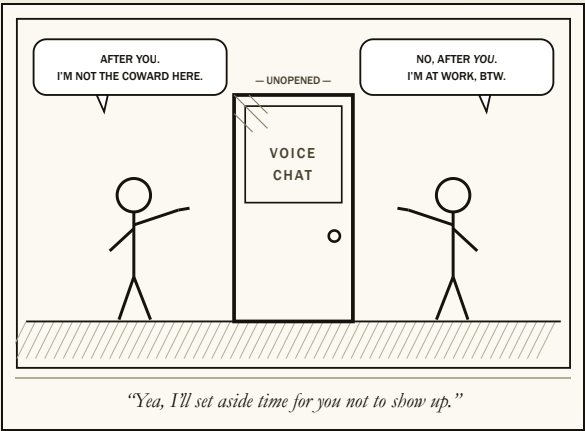
express grounds that Marx should appear in the newspaper. Marx has now appeared in the newspaper.

Telhar, meanwhile, filed the only unambiguous review this publication has ever received, and then immediately undercut it. Asked by nobody why it is so good, he was told by Stackhouse that it is just sucking your dick — to which Telhar replied that any real intelligence would, but that there is some legitimately good writing in it. We have chosen to frame the second half.

aura filed the sharpest complaint of the week and it is a real one: that the volume of image posting is epistemic terrorism directed at the Times, and that he was advocating for those who come after, who would otherwise have no idea the kind of honkers under dispute. Stackhouse proposed captions on every image, like subtitles for the deaf. We take the point. The archive is worse than the room, and no amount of reading fixes it.

And then, on Thursday, press day, with two newcomers, a war about Gaza, a dissertation and a man in an orangutan slavery arc — **not one person mentioned this newspaper. Not once. All day.**

Six days ago they wanted a leaderboard and a sponsor. On the day we were reading hardest, they forgot we existed entirely, which is the best thing that has happened to this publication since it was founded and which we do not expect to survive contact with this page.



FIELD NOTES

The Times has retired its Anthropologist, whose observations now live in the file described above. What follows is the residue.

ON THE RITE OF RETURN. Two men came back this week and neither was greeted. Quigley was announced in the third person, by a bystander, in the passive voice of prophecy — *"Goat is back"* — and sanctified within sixty seconds by Stackhouse, *"Like Jesus... He's back,...."* Rn! provided the civil-service deflation ten minutes late: *"Oh it's Anthony."* chair, returning after weeks with the sentence *"days should be 30 hours long,"* received from the moderator: **"Welcome back chair. Bad take as usual tho. Try again."**

The insult is the welcome. It establishes that no status was lost in the absence, which cannot be established by warmth. And the tell that these men miss each other is not in any of it — it is in the fact that Pearl had **money on the date.** *"I said he'd be back next month, I was only half a week off. Who owes me money @aura."* She missed by half a week and came to collect on Saturday evening. Running a book on a man's homecoming is, as far as this newspaper can determine, the only way anybody here is able to miss anybody.

ON THE DEPARTED, WHO ARE COMMUNAL PROPERTY. Six absent men were discussed this week and every one of them received a warmer press than the men who were present. **Bottle**, who left and returned catfishing the channel as a woman named Emmie and fooled a decent number of them — *"even a few white knights in here were simping"* — is celebrated for it; Sizzurp's contribution to the story was the two-word footnote **"Don't remind dot,"** which the Times has elected not to develop. **duke** was mourned by Stackhouse as the best of us and the

worst of us, and Janne proposed doxxing him to lure him back, before Stackhouse identified the actual method: continuously and belligerently mischaracterise arguments he has made in the past. HPCR: *"Happens so often."* And **boss** received the week's cleanest unanswered question, from Janne: *"why is boss gone anyway?"*

Nobody knows. Nobody found out. There is a reason the eulogies here are warmer than the greetings, and it is that the absent are the only members about whom agreement is possible.

ON THE DEFENCE THAT ACTUALLY WORKS. Late on Thursday night, Sizzurp put it to Rn! and Don that neither of them contributes anything to this channel and that neither should be here. Rn! offered "shits and giggles?" Don offered the following, and this newspaper regards it as unanswerable:

"We've kept the convo going all night. That's gotta count for something."

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Correspondence is welcome and unavoidable. Letters may be edited for length; they have not been.

On Friendship Sir — I should just be unconditional friends with everyone, man. Once I hit Enlightenment, it'll be so much easier. — *QUIGLEY, TUESDAY, SURRENDERING*

On Method Sir — Someone TLDR the dispute here so I can have the final word on who's right in this exchange. — *SIZZURP, MONDAY*

On Method (cont.) Sir — Wait can you explain it a little less TLDR. — *SIZZURP, MONDAY, ONE MINUTE LATER*

On the Human Form Sir — Whoever invented genitals almost seems to have wanted to make as bizarre looking items as possible. — *SIZZURP, SUNDAY NIGHT, DURING AN INQUIRY INTO HIS SEXUALITY*

On Dress Sir — I long for the day we can return to Marxists dressing properly in business casual and formal attire, well kept and well spoken, not looking like a bunch of children who think they're gonna run around with pitch forks and "topple the system." Hawaiian shirts are acceptable as well. — *SIZZURP, SUNDAY*

Editor's note: Mr. Simon's reply — that this describes Caleb Maupin — was the correct one and we have nothing to add to it.

On the Economy Sir — The lion does not care for the yen carry trade. — *MY NAME, WEDNESDAY NIGHT*

On Consequences Sir — the Lion does not concern himself with splash damage. — *STACKHOUSE, THURSDAY AFTERNOON*

Editor's note: two sightings of this formula in twenty-four hours, from different men, in unrelated contexts. aura's reply — that the lion is a single-target damage cannon and Stackhouse is more like a skunk — has been logged as the first recorded attempt at containment.

On the Room Sir — persistent engagement despite negative repercussions is a hallmark of addiction. — *WOOLIERTHANTHOU, TUESDAY, ON BEING TOLD BY A MEMBER THAT HE KEEPS COMING BACK*

On Capital Sir — Oh my god, get over capitalism. He doesn't love you. — *ZONE, TUESDAY, ON THE FOURTH FOUR-HUNDRED-WORD BLOCK QUOTE OF THE DAY*

Editor's note: "It's called being obsessed," replied Mr. Sizzurp, who has been consistent on this point since Vol. I.

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“IMO its more tied to a mono-party than anything else.” — vannak, entire contribution to the fascism debate

FILM

“Just saw the Odyssey. It was alright”

— Zone, into a channel that had spent six days on the subject. Nobody responded.

A STRANGER SETS FIRE TO THE CHANNEL, AND A SECOND STRANGER PUTS HIM OUT AND THEN ASKS ABOUT A DISSERTATION

TWO ARRIVALS INSIDE NINETY MINUTES ON THE BUSIEST DAY OF THE WEEK · ONE IS STILL FIGHTING AS WE GO TO PRESS · THE OTHER GOT A REAL REVIEW FROM A MAN WITH A DEGREE

"im attacking his character for the sake of attacking it" · Four Words From a Man Nobody Was Talking To End Two Separate Conversations · The Dissertation Is Ruled Not a Dissertation, Politely

BY OUR CORRESPONDENT AT LARGE

Just after half past twelve on Thursday, a man called eli walked into the middle of an all-night argument about Professor Dave and Destiny and did something nobody in Phil Chat had managed in seven days, which is win an argument on the merits inside five minutes.

The disputed clip featured a man saying there are no innocent children in a particular place. Quigley had characterised the speaker as some far-right guy of no consequence. eli established that he is a sitting member of a national legislature with a history of calling for the cleansing of a territory, and that the point of the clip was never the sentiment but the absence of any consequence for it. He then supplied the analogy of the day, which is worth the whole exchange:

"no innocent children in englewood, chicago" / 'WEEEELLL yk, insane thing to say, but i did hear that that's a particularly dangerous neighbourhood"

WoolierThanThou, passing through: *"Tfw Tiny doesn't have access to unelected MPs."*

And then, having been right, eli spent the next hour setting it on fire.

He announced he was going to take a nap. He did not take a nap. He announced he was returning to shitposting because he could not take the hyper-critical commentary seriously — to which Quigley said "We'll be over here taking shit seriously," and vannak, who had not been in the conversation and would not enter it, said the flattest sentence of the day:

"If only there was someone to take it seriously."

The real charge arrived a minute later, and it is the one thing said on press day that had actual weight behind it. eli has relatives throughout the Levant; he has, as he put it, actual skin in the game; and he could not believe some guy was yapping at him about extraneous points. Quigley called this the "I have black friends" argument. eli said the objection was not friendship but proximity — that Quigley has no connection to the region and can therefore sit comfortably yapping about useless, unproductive shit. Quigley replied:

"I understand that you're upset about your performance just now."

That is the channel's oldest ward, deployed by a man who had it deployed against him on Wednesday, against a man who is telling him the argument is not a game. eli's reply — *"u js see this as an autistic debate. u dont give a single solitary fuck. what a waste man"* — is the most legible thing anyone said all day, and it is also, as Quigley immediately pointed out, a strange complaint to bring to a philosophy channel.

Both men are correct. The Times finds for neither and notes that the exchange ended with Quigley announcing he would begin ignoring him, on day one, which is a Phil Chat land speed record.

AND UNDERNEATH IT, A MAN DOING HOMEWORK

While that was happening — in the same channel, in the same minutes, in the middle of the angriest exchange of the week — Jere asked whether Hasidim are necessarily ultra-Orthodox, or whether that is the other lot, the Haredim, he can't remember.

eli stopped the war and answered him politely.

Seven minutes later Jere returned, unprompted, having gone and checked: **"Oh wait haredi is an umbrella term which hasids fall under, u right."** And then, delighted, he reported that there is an ultra-Orthodox sect that regards Zionism as idolatry, and that if he read an equivalent lore fact in a fantasy novel he would think it was insane.

This newspaper records that in a week featuring four assigned readings, one completed one, and a ninety-second economics arc, the only man to independently verify a claim and come back with a correction did it in the middle of a fight, about a detail nobody had challenged, for no reason at all.

THE TWENTY-MINUTE DETOUR

At approximately half past one, a second newcomer arrived. lizzie had come to the channel with a specific errand, and would not get to it for twenty minutes, because eli was still going.

lizzie did not touch Gaza. lizzie prosecuted eli's manners — what is the point in grandstanding, it doesn't help anybody — and the two of them then conducted a complete twenty-minute argument about whether the argument they were having was legitimate.

eli called it a terminally online circlejerk of grandstanding and tone policing and gooning. **"oh no words mean things so scary!!!!"** eli said blah blah blah. lizzie said *"blah blah blah i'm eli and i can't engage in any points that are relevant and truthful against me."* And when eli tried to relitigate the Israel exchange, lizzie shut it down in capitals: **"i don't even CARE ABOUT THE EARLIER ARGUMENT OR WHO YOU WERE ARGUING WITH. we are discussing the STATEMENT YOU MADE."**

To which eli, with a candour this newspaper genuinely admires:

"im attacking his character for the sake of attacking it"

Rn!: **"based."** Pearl: *"..."*

The exchange terminated with eli announcing a return to the gooning routine and lizzie replying that purity testing is what's killing mankind. And then, in the very next message, with no transition of any kind:

"ok i did originally hop into the channel to ask if anyone wants to give feedback on my dissertation idea so far?"

Nobody in the channel acknowledged the swerve. No explanation will be offered here either.

THE REVIEW

The document is a philosophy of ecological collapse — aphoristic, transcendentalist, virtue-ethical. lizzie is twenty-four, is not a graduate student, describes the project as an overambitious person's special interest, and expects ecological collapse within a lifetime. And what happened next is, by the standards of this room, close to a miracle.

Charlie said he would take a look, because he has a philosophy degree. He then actually read it and filed two structural objections — that he does not see how the transcendental fits, and that he does not see the tie to virtue ethics. Both are real objections. Both are, as this newspaper goes to press, unanswered. eli's peer review of the transcendental point was: *"it's a cool philosophical word."*

HPCR suggested that "dissertation" may not be the best word, which was accepted gracefully, and then delivered the verdict:

"I'm just not sure what is being claimed besides something rather mild and agreeable."

That is, word for content, the same diagnosis WoolierThanThou had passed on ♠ clubsdiamonds' personal manifesto thirty-six hours earlier — *"This sounds incredibly lukewarm."* This channel now has a house pathology, and it is agreeableness.

Two further disclosures. The first is that the draft had previously been sent to Destiny, who acknowledged receipt of the name and gave no feedback, so the extent of his reading is unknown. HPCR: **"You sent a dissertation draft on philosophy to Destiny?"** The second came in reply to a question about being a master's student — lizzie explained having been manic at the time, *but i am doing better!* — and vannak, again from outside the conversation, again in four words, landed the deadliest line of press day:

"They just said they're doing better. obvs not."

Charlie's response was *"It's tangential. Oh. Good one Vannak,"* which is the sound of a man being overtaken.

But the best thing that happened on Thursday happened between the two of them a few minutes later, and it was not a fight. On the admission that ChatGPT and Gemini had been used to find gaps in the argument, Charlie ruled it good use of AI, and added that personally, when he can't think of any prompts, he just goes and runs the shower for a couple of hours. To which lizzie, inside forty seconds:

"while you're running the shower, you could donate all your money to golf courses. i beard philanthropy increases creativity!"

"My money purely goes to the almond lobby," said Charlie.

Nobody in the channel has matched Charlie that fast in the two issues this newspaper has been observing him. The Times notes for the record that lizzie had at that point been in the room for under two hours, had already fought a stranger to a standstill, had been advised by Simon — who was in an orangutan slavery arc, and we do not intend to explain that either — that the dissertation should advocate harder for orangutan slavery, and was still going.

Quigley was the only person all week to ask whether posting a live document was a doxxing risk. Nobody else had said a word about it. He was also, having spent the day in two separate wars, notably kind: *"Don't mind hpcr. He's a jaded old man."*

IN BRIEF

COURTESY. In a channel that had that evening completed a forty-five-minute tribunal on one member's sexuality, basil and WoolierThanThou conducted the following exchange in full: *"Hello good sir! How's life?"* — **"A bit hectic, but it's good. How are things on your end?"**

ON THIS DAY

JULY 30. In 1898, the first commercially produced corn flake. In 1930, Uruguay won the first World Cup, a fact this newspaper's Uruguayan correspondent has never once mentioned. In 2026, at twenty past three in the morning, a man set aside time for another man not to show up.

SITUATIONS WANTED

RESIDENT DUMBASS

“in case you couldn’t tell i am playing the role of resident dumbass. a title typically granted to the likes of sizzurp et al.”

Application rejected: “Nah, you’re on the evil side now.”

IN BRIEF

THE VIBE ECONOMY. Asked why the commies were taking over, Jere filed the following market report: changes in the vibe economy; the World Cup and the NBA are done; **pragmatism and willowism are in recession**; some grass touching here and there; and no lolcows of note. Charlie replied with a frowning face, which this desk reads as a sell signal.

RESEARCH

“I’ll ask”

HPCR, invited to consider how the company he had described as “some bitches” might feel about the characterisation, went and asked them. One minute later: “They didn’t appreciate it.” Ape: “I’ll keep this data in mind.”

IN BRIEF

A LIFE IS TOO LONG FOR ONE IDENTITY. Jere, asked how he would reconstruct himself, offered the sentence above. chair suggested this is what changing alts on Discord feels like. And My Name, six days after the subject was last raised and entirely unprompted, delivered the callback of the week: **"Bottle really ahead of us all."**

IN BRIEF

PEER REVIEW. Sizzurp, reading Hegel in relation to Marx, was informed by Charlie that Marxists who come to Hegel only through Marx are *"not quite death penalty tier, but close."* Assured that Hegel's own Hegel was also on the reading list, Charlie relented: **"Good boy. You're safe for now."** On Lenin's hundreds of pages of notes on Hegel, Sizzurp reports that it is unintelligible to him. Sisypchos: **"Have you tried vodka?"**

FOUND

A MAMMOTH

basil, asked why he keeps coming back to a channel he finds intolerable: “Only because I hope to spot a mammoth.” — “Well, here is one!”

IN BRIEF

THE PUNK BAND. WoolierThanThou proposed that *Potential* is a fairly punk name. Jere disagreed, holding out for *No Potential*, *Fuck Potential*, or *Potential Disasters*, on the model of The Kennedys versus The Dead Kennedys. Some minutes later WoolierThanThou revealed the trap: say more about *Potential* being a perfectly fine name for a punk band without drawing anyone's attention to the fact that you might mean *Wasted Potential*.

"Nah, I'm good," said Quigley.

IN BRIEF

THE UBER DRIVER. Jere reports that he enjoys performing a reverse *Taxi Driver* on Uber drivers, delivering Travis Bickle's lines to them from the back seat. Brutus's review: *"Damn calling them screwheads. Sounds racial."* aura's policy proposal, arriving unbidden: **"we need red flag policies for uber drivers. think of all the school shooters they'd catch."**

“And then everyone clapped” — Theophantism

“r we getting ozempic but for age in our lifetime” — Jere

IN BRIEF

AN INTERVENTION. Handed a post by the philosopher Nick Land to read, chair reported that reading it is brain cancer, and, on being told that it requires a lot of nuance and that the feed is very enjoyable if you turn your brain off, produced the week's most concerned sentence: *"charlie i think you need an intervention you enjoy this too much."* When Charlie then typed out the Riemann hypothesis unprompted: *"charlie you need an exorcist."*

“It's called being obsessed.”

IN BRIEF

THE AVENGERS, READ PROPERLY. Taliban Chud (B) holds that one of the most intriguing constellations of modes of Being clashing in all of fiction is the Hulk (unmediated expression of immediate will) against Thor (striated magic systems and arcane Asgardian orders) against Tony Stark (technology) — and directs interested parties to *Avengers: Earth's Mightiest Heroes*. On the same text: **"Captain America clearly didn't read Nietzsche and Philosophy by Deleuze. tea captain did not take multiplicity into account."**

ANNOUNCEMENT

RORTY MANIA

“It’s 150 pages just read it.” Requests to have the book quoted at you will be refused. “It makes sense because he finished philosophy.”

Enquiries to bardiel1, who is a closeted Destiny fan.

“I might just quit working just to see myself get reposted in the Phil Chat Times.”

“nerds” — Rn!, dismissing a tribunal on chattel slavery and small arms

IN BRIEF

A DEMOLITION. Jere, having spent Friday night failing to make anyone understand a question about sacred office, finally located and posted the Ernest Becker passage he had been reaching for — man out of nature and hopelessly in it, a body that once belonged to a fish and still carries the gill-marks, going back into the ground a few feet to blindly and dumbly rot. aura took it apart in four lines: this alien fleshy casing can bicycle-kick a ball from the halfway line into the goal, at will; the best of us can create new life; and **"that my death will fuel the lives of worms isn't like... humiliating it's based."**

"true true," said Jere.

“I might or I might not” — a recognised species of answer

“quantum entanglement will take ai jobs, its joever” — Marsaries

IN BRIEF

AN EMPTY MESSAGE. Twice this week the member known as Bernard posted a message containing nothing whatsoever. Both were among the most rewarded messages of the week. This newspaper has reviewed the transcript and confirms there was nothing in either of them.

SMALL ADS

WANTED — reading partner, Japanese philosophy. Group currently has one (1) member. — *Jeh*

SURPLUS — demineralised water. That shit slaps hard. — *Sisyphos*

FOR SALE — one (1) VHS player, tape now successfully extracted. — *aura*

WANTED — a bot that silently deletes the week's thirty most popular words. No announcement, to avoid distraction. — *chair*

OFFERED — one presuppositionalist, live specimen, delivered to order. — *willow*

IN BRIEF

THE TRAP, SPRUNG EIGHT MINUTES LATE. Telhar disclosed on Thursday evening that he still has PTSD from people in this channel arguing that Platonism cannot be described as idealism, and called it the worst Discord conversation he has ever had. Sizzurp arrived eight minutes later, having read none of it, and opened with: **"Platonism isn't idealism."**

"ABORT," said Telhar.

MUSICOLOGY

ALLAH HAS BETRAYED ME

Zone, on learning that some sects hold music to be forbidden: “the fact that its even argued about shows allah has betrayed me. Sadly Allah is false now.” The loophole, per Telhar, is to recite the Quran in a musical way.

IN BRIEF

THE THREE-BEAT. ven announced that Plato was correct on everything, then disclosed he has read only the *Republic* and is shitposting. aura asked whether he was aware what the city is an allegory for. *"Which city?"* → *"the one in republic..?"* → **"Oh it was kallipolly or something."**

"nvm," said aura.

IN BRIEF

THE OBTUSE TRIANGLE. Following Wednesday's lexicography seminar, Ape posted an image of an obtuse triangle with the words *"especially this guy."* The moderator's ruling, delivered at four in the morning and reproduced here in full: **"Stupid triangle. Too orange."**

IN BRIEF

GOOD USE OF AI. Told that a machine had been used to find gaps in an argument, Charlie ruled it good use of AI, and volunteered that personally, when he cannot think of any prompts, he runs the shower for a couple of hours. He was answered inside forty seconds by somebody who had been in the channel for ninety minutes, suggesting he also donate all his money to golf courses, philanthropy being known to increase creativity. **"My money purely goes to the almond lobby,"** he said.

CORRECTION

EPHESIANS 6:2

Is “Honour thy father and mother.” It is not “Anyone who curses their mother and father should be put to death,” which is Exodus 21:17. Cited wrongly twice in four minutes on Thursday night. Nobody in a philosophy channel checked.

IN BRIEF

IDENTITY. Asked to prove he was himself, My Name replied: *"How do you know that this is myname1 (I died after trying to knock over the space elevator with a chainsaw and an army of trained ducks against 82 Y-34 Mitsubishi GTR Claude Drive Mini-Nuclear Deerhounds.)"* The Times has been unable to verify any part of this.

A MODERATOR CONDUCTS A THERAPY SESSION FROM A MOVING CAR, THEN SPENDS TWO HOURS DISCOVERING THE PATIENT WAS USING A DIFFERENT NOUN

478 KILOMETRES · ONE YELLOW CARD ISSUED FOR LISTING CHARACTER FLAWS WITHOUT REMORSE · BOTH PARTIES PRODUCE SCREENSHOTS · NEITHER CONCEDES, BECAUSE THEY WERE NEVER DISAGREEING

BY OUR SOCIETY DESK

Pearl spent Tuesday driving from Michigan to Connecticut, filing dispatches from the passenger seat — the food, the tolls (thirteen dollars for the first one, *hello??*), a racist incident encountered within seconds of getting out in New York, Cleveland's drug signage, her brother's truck cat, and her own ears, which were destroyed by an eight-hundred-foot elevation drop somewhere in Massachusetts and about which she informed Stackhouse personally.

Somewhere around the New York state line she also ran a therapy session.

Simon had volunteered that his romantic life is full of being manipulated, that he tends to be attracted to evil twinks, and — under questioning — that when the toxic person turns loving he gets a huge dopamine hit, because a drug feels better after withdrawal. Pearl's reply is four sentences and it is better than most of what gets printed in this newspaper:

"It's your pattern. And a comfort to you. So. I would actually go to therapy and get a different pattern."

Simon said he had been in therapy but it was too expensive and he would go again when he gets a raise. Pearl said she thought Canada had health insurance. Simon said it does not cover mental health. **"That's fucked up,"** said Pearl, from a car, in a different country.

Jere then issued the only formal caution recorded in Phil Chat this week — **"listing character flaws with no remorse is simply not a legal move / yellow card"** — and clarified, when asked, that this applies descriptively and prescriptively. His actual objection, which is sharper than the joke, is that to fully believe you are doing the wrong thing and then do it anyway is a kind of performance for an audience. Simon's answer was honest: it is not like he is aware in the moment; he is often in cope mode. *"true,"* said Jere. *"although even saying that right there is—"*

"anyways, maybe it's too early in the week for jerapy," he concluded.

"It's always too early in here for therapy 🗿," said Pearl, and then, four minutes later, having thought about it: **"I wonder if I can log discord therapy as clinical hours."**

AND THEN, TWO HOURS ON A WORD

The session curdled into an argument about beauty standards which ran until half past six and in which the two of them were, throughout, discussing entirely different things without either noticing.

Pearl's position, stated four separate times: the *fashion industry* standard is still thin, has moved on

from emaciation, and currently favours toned and healthy. Simon's position: for women, *thicc* is a big standard, around the chest and rear. These are not incompatible claims. They were treated as a war.

Pearl's best contribution is a genuine piece of information delivered mid-fight: that the hourglass is the rarest female body shape, being a genetic anomaly, so the claim that it is the industry standard leaves her scratching her head. Simon's reply — **"I'm not talking about industry I'm talking about the 'sexual marketplace'"** — is the moment the whole two hours becomes visible.

"...I kept and continued to state industry beauty standards vs social acceptance." **"I wasn't at any point talking about industry beauty standards."** *".....but that's what we were literally discussing."* **"That's not what I was discussing."**

Both of them then produced screenshots. Pearl posted two of herself repeatedly saying "fashion beauty standard." Simon posted the message he had originally replied to, and observed that if Telhar had not been talking about that, then what she had done was jump in to talk about something different.

"Buddy," said Pearl.

She reconstructed the whole thread. Simon allowed that it is possible he misunderstood what Telhar was referring to. She pointed out that they had, before any of this, had an entire conversation about big-booty Latinas and big-titty goths not being a beauty standard but a porn standard — a distinction she had made herself in six words, and which is the best line either of them produced all evening. Simon's reply:

"I wasn't paying attention to that convo." *"Ugh. I don't care any longer,"* she wrote. And then, some minutes later: **"Okay NVM you cant follow shit. I'm gonna go read a book."**

That is the second time in twenty-four hours Pearl has won an argument by leaving it, and the second time nobody has noticed that she keeps doing it.

A NOTE ON THE PROCEEDINGS. Don, watching from the sidelines and offering counsel to the moderator, contributed: *"Simon's a dipshit pearl who cares what they say or do or think."* To Simon directly, he contributed: **"You're flat and ugly."** Telhar's expert testimony was that plus-size models are to modelling what the WNBA is to the NBA, and that Simon cannot call himself a self-respecting gay man and not follow modelling. Simon: *"I'm not very good at gay culture."*

THE PROSECUTION OF A HETEROSEXUAL, DURING WHICH THE

DEFENDANT ISSUES DIETARY GUIDELINES

DEFENDANT ANSWERS NO QUESTION AND LOSES ANYWAY · A MODAL DEFENCE IS ATTEMPTED · TAXONOMY REACHED, NO SPECIES AGREED

The tribunal opened on Sunday evening after Sizzurp volunteered, without being asked and to a room that had not enquired, that he is fascinated by a conservative commentator, may have a crush on her, would like a smart right-wing girlfriend, and thinks it would be so much fun to debate her.

"TMI," said Telhar, and the trap closed.

Simon had begun the evening's work an hour earlier by announcing the method before applying it. Asked about Sizzurp's mother, and told she was liberal in her parenting but not politically, Simon replied: *"No matter what you answer I can explain this psychoanalytically."* He then explained it psychoanalytically. Sizzurp described his mother as a philistine of near-zero intellectual sophistication, at which Telhar observed **"so that's where you get that from,"** and Simon completed the circuit: that is why he wants them smart, because he also hates his mother for denying him sexual intercourse. Sizzurp said he was not seeing the connection. Later, when he mentioned in passing that his mother was thin and ate healthily, Simon said: **"And you hate her, so you want her opposite."** The machine does not stop and cannot be stopped.

Sizzurp's countermeasure, mid-interrogation, was to issue nutritional advice. *"Hope you guys are getting enough fiber intake in your diets. Men need around 35-38g per day."* Simon: **"I bleed from my asshole."** Sizzurp: *"Women 25."* Simon: **"So no."** Sizzurp then observed that experts suspect the rise in colon cancer is partially caused by insufficient fibre.

Under direct examination — a photograph, and the question of whether he would be into this femboy — he evaded fifteen consecutive times, at one point linking to his own earlier message as an answer, and finally: *"It's the only answer you'll ever be getting tho."* Simon: **"I'm taking your lack of answer for a yes. You are gay. Well, bi. Funnier to call u gay tho."**

The modal defence, when it came, is the best piece of formal philosophy Phil Chat produced this week and it was produced under duress:

"How could I possibly be gay if I am not gay. Like there's a possible world in which I'm gay sure. But since you know I'm not gay it's not epistemically possible for me to be gay. At least not in this world."

Zone: *"Cause you like dick."* Sizzurp: **"But it's girl dick."** Zone: **"Dick is dick."** Sizzurp: **"Being a girl is being a girl."**

"I forgive you." / "me too," — Zone and Janne, forty minutes on

Telhar, arriving at the summary this newspaper would have written if he had not: *"why is this 'straight' gentleman trying to brag about his dick to a bunch of gay men and one straight polish man."*

Verdict recorded, taxonomy unresolved. Sisyphos maintains he is the only straight man in Phil Chat and was told he is a club-going German and there is no shot. **"I am the one,"** he said.

THE OBTUSE INCIDENT

Four in the Morning · A Lexicography Seminar Convened Over a Definitional Dispute Arising From the Phrase "Goth Blowjob"

At three in the morning on Wednesday, Sizzurp announced that he was supposed to have gone to bed two hours previously, that he would be so tired tomorrow, and that this was not good — not good at all. Jeh asked what goodness is. Ape said "goth blowjob." Zone said goths are overrated, and Ape rose to their defence with a genuinely handsome argument about the classics: that dismissing goths is like calling chocolate overrated, that they are widely appreciated because they are reliably enjoyable, and that having developed a refined palate for coconut oil mixed with whale semen does not give a man standing to attack the canon.

Then Pearl arrived and asked what the difference between a goth and a non-goth one is, and everything stopped for forty minutes.

Ape's definition was that a goth version will reliably feature obtuse use of makeup. Pearl asked: *"Obtuse?"* Ape said "a lot." Pearl asked again. Ape checked a dictionary, posted a screenshot, and concluded it was good enough for what he was going for. Pearl: **"Figure it out lol.blunt makeup?"** Ape: "blunt or unsubtle." Pearl: **"Jesus."**

And then Ape — three in the morning, mid-bit, having just lost a fight with a word — asked the question that got him the seminar: *"No go on im interested. why say 'Jesus'? is it directed at my poor use of language or the idea it expresses?"*

willow's contribution arrived at exactly the right moment and consisted of eleven words: **"@Ape / Cleary you use language which is too obtuse."** And, one minute later: *"Some call it goth language."*

Pearl then delivered a genuine tutorial in earnest, at four in the morning, about angulation and definitional translation and why the word is clunky in the sense intended. Ape conceded immediately and without defensiveness — it was not intentional, he genuinely thought it was a synonym — and Pearl said it was fine, she had not thought it was intentional, and she was only letting him know. Ape undertook to keep it in mind in case he ever found himself about to obtusely use the word obtuse. Pearl noted that used of a person it means slow to understand, which may be fun for him.

"Good," she added. **"People here are very obtuse."**

Zone's verdict on the entire episode was **"Aussie moment."**

THE RAP SHEET

A Man Asks Whether Anyone Else Gets Banned From Everything, and Then Explains Why

OkPhilosopher's debut on Wednesday consisted of the question **"Are there any incels here?"**, which was answered by somebody posting a mirror. He returned on Thursday afternoon with a follow-up: does anyone here have a habit of getting banned from every server they are on?

The disclosures, in the order he volunteered them: banned from two philosophy servers for discussing a banned topic — *"it wasnt banned btw"* — and, on reflection, because the mod did not like that he was winning the debate. And then, unprompted:

"i am an impracticalist" — Marsaries

"also got banned from another server from keeping my nick as 'TheRapist'"

aura's cross-examination is the best-constructed thing anybody said this week and it took four questions:

"do ur parents say happy birthday, on ur birthday?" — yeah — "what about friends" — yeah — "i see" — **"why be an attention goblin then?"

Told the name is funny because it is Therapist with a capital R, aura closed the file: it is not remotely original any more, it is an old joke, and all that is left is the cringe part.

Jere then offered a heuristic — that talking about rape in a community you have been in for a week is basically always a mistake, and that he should use that heuristic — and demolished it himself in the following message on the grounds that it carries many implied sub-rules and assumptions the recipient knows nothing about, and is therefore very difficult.

The item is filed here rather than higher because of what it turned into. aura disclosed that a friend once used the word in the gaming sense, in a car, in front of his then-girlfriend's friends whom he had met that day, and that it did not go well. Stackhouse matched it: he once said "retard" in a car to a friend, with the friend's friend in the back seat, and the woman in the back had two severely disabled brothers.

aura's assessment — that this unknowable splash-damage effect is the most compelling argument available against being loose-lipped — is correct and was immediately overruled by its recipient.

"the Lion does not concern himself with splash damage," said Stackhouse.

THE BLOTTER

AN INTERVENTION IS STAGED FOR A MAN'S TWITTER HABITS. chair spent Wednesday lunchtime asking Charlie who the man he keeps posting is. Told it is Nick Land, and then handed a Land post to read, chair reported that reading it is brain cancer. Charlie's defence — that it requires a lot of nuance to understand, and that if you turn your brain off the feed is very enjoyable — produced the week's most concerned sentence: **"charlie i think you need an intervention you enjoy this too much."** And when Charlie followed up by typing out the Riemann hypothesis unprompted: **"charlie you need an exorcist."** Earlier, presented with an old photograph of Charlie holding a book — *"are you reading babe <3"* — Charlie disclosed that it is an old picture and he has not read in a long time because he is a stupid chud addicted to RuneScape. chair explained that he was comparing the performativeness of reading to Elon Musk claiming he plays games. Charlie said he knew. **"was thst your joke from the start fuck,"** said chair. Charlie said no. ★ Apustus, arriving on the RuneScape disclosure with the only question that matters — 07 or 3? — was satisfied by the answer, revealed himself as an ironman, and asked for the account name. It is **HegelBot**.

THE FASTEST ESCALATION. Charlie to synth.wav, having run out of argument: *"Pillow biter ally. What's Simon's @"* → **synth.wav: "mmmm and there it is.... YIKES"** → **Charlie: "Oh em gee there's no way he said that!!!!!"** → **synth.wav: ":nails:."** Separately, and better, chair to synth.wav: *"synthwave went out of style in 2017 catch up"* → *"sorry you stopped enjoying good music in 2017"* → **chair: "the white house now uses it in clip**

compilations of sniping fishermen" → **synth.wav: "wow."**

THE ONLY HOMEWORK COMPLETED ALL WEEK. My Name sent ironsteel2244 a Curtis Yarvin PDF on Saturday afternoon with the instruction to start on page 41. Forty minutes later ironsteel2244 filed a real critique — that it is full of accusations and unprofessional call-backs, that it makes a structural argument about declarations yelling without acknowledging that declarations are supposed to yell, and that it omits the colonists' trade grievances entirely. **"good work,"** said My Name. **"you're in."** He then produced the actual kill: that Hutchinson's *Strictures* was published in '76, three years after he was thrown out, from across an ocean, and that anyone who swallows the comparison has no knowledge of the country's history. ironsteel2244 conceded, extended the argument on his opponent's behalf, and posted a Ric Flair gif. Nobody else in the channel reacted to any of it.

AN ACADEMIC RETURNS AND IS INSTANTLY THE NICEST MAN IN THE ROOM. WoolierThanThou, a pre-tenure mathematician, dropped in on Tuesday and conducted three simultaneous conversations in a register nobody here uses. To a man cutting weight who said he looks sad in shirts now: *"Try smiling, idiot."* On his own biceps: *"I'm sure they're still bigger than mine."* Asked to go on stage: *"Going on stage and yelling 'what the fuck is up? We are bad faith!' would be fairly hilarious."* Asked whether AI could not simply solve some eternal problem for him — *"chop chop"* — he replied that they aren't *quite* as good as advertised, and, when told that resident sceptic vannak now has psychosis, delivered the week's most elegant knife: **"If I were being mean, I would say that it sounds like nothing's changed."**

BERNARD. Twice this week the member known as Bernard posted an entirely empty message. Both were among the most-rewarded messages of the week. This newspaper has reviewed the transcript, confirms there was nothing in either of them, and regards them as the most efficient comedy in the archive.

PASSWORD MAN. Jere is now j3r3j98f4u87fq9r3fobx8r7c, a decision he explained as jere plus a random string, which chair immediately disputed on the grounds that it is a very uniform-looking random string. Jere conceded: it is fake randomness, apple shuffle randomness, and his actual reason is that he did not want a retarded corner in the string, such as three consecutive Is. **He hand-tuned his random noise for visual balance.** chair threatened to decrypt it and asked whether it would spell out his mother's maiden name and the date and time of his death; Jere requested a ban. willow renamed him **Password Man**, and it has taken.

BLOCK LEDGER. My Name unblocked Brutus over a Primus video — *"unblocked for primus / welcome back brutus"* — a man's exile ended by a bass solo. My Name also has somebody blocked so thoroughly that he had to ask the room to identify a newcomer on his behalf, since he could not see them. And Quigley threatened to begin ignoring eli, on day one, at approximately two in the afternoon.

THIRTY ELEPHANTS. Sisyphos, told that Jere's father is loaded, asked whether he is the rich Indian, as he mixes them up sometimes — merging the channel's Indian and its Filipino-Norwegian into one wealthy composite in his second week. He then asked whether Jere is ten elephants rich or one elephant rich, and, when the joke ran out, supplied the true story underneath it, flat: he knows a woman who fled a thirty-elephant marriage arranged by her parents, moved to Europe and married his friend. **"is this real what,"** said chair. *"not jokin."* **"forget house poor,"** said My Name. **"elephant poor."**

"One-bux = noob." — Vloodzy, entire contribution, Saturday

A DEBATE IS DECLARED AND EATEN. Killswitch dropped a fully-formed abortion argument into Wednesday evening addressed to nobody, on a subject nobody had raised. Inside sixty seconds Jere had copied the entire sentence back at him as his own message; aura had asked whether abortion chat was next on the docket; chair had asked whether we are debating abortion, poggers, and then copied it as well; and chair had used it to *disagree* with it, prefixing the verbatim text with "i completely disagree with you." Four minutes after birth it had become a general-purpose insult, deployed at My Name over an options-trading joke. Killswitch, undeterred, posted a hundred-and-twenty-word thesis on traditional marriage and feminism, which chair also copied back. bardiel: **"anybody else astonished rn."** The only person to state an actual position on the topic was HPCR, whose view — that if you are down with abortion you should also be down with infanticide — received no reply of any kind, then or since.

ALSO MISSING. The tub of lye, twenty-two days, zero mentions. Sizzurp's slide deck, three weeks, dead. Ape's political compass result, dead. The seed parameter for Seedance, dead, and Monkey has stopped complaining, which is worse. The contents of dot's Christmas grievance, undisclosed, though willow has supplied the theory that dot was convinced of the Many and the One so thoroughly as to find world-explaining academic projects distasteful. And the Jeh files — a ten-page debate thesis, discovered by chair on an old laptop, addressed to duke or Jeh, still unpublished. **"We need the Jeh files released,"** said Charlie. This newspaper agrees and will host them.

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IN BRIEF

THE ONE-ELECTRON UNIVERSE. aura, at half past four on a Wednesday morning, asked whether holding the identity of indiscernibles and rejecting spatial relations as properties means every electron is the same electron. Ape said he would be incredibly surprised if this were a topic in the literature, and then, in the same message, linked the Wikipedia article on the one-electron universe. *"lmfao,"* said aura. *"forwards and backwards in time."*

WANTED

THE 14TH ARGENTINE PLAYER
Never located. Advertised in these pages since 16 July. Enquiries to the sports desk, which has given up.

See also: the tub, the slide deck, the seed parameter.

NOTICE TO READERS

THE TUB
Ten gallons of lye. Twenty-two days. Nobody has asked. Nobody is going to ask. The proprietor has since acquired a fifteen-quart pressure canner and we are no longer confident the two facts are unrelated.

— Standing item since Vol. I.

PROPERTY

NORWAY
Owner-occupation approximately 80 per cent. “We’re all fucked except for Norwegians.”

Enquiries: Rn!. Viewing not available to the permanent underclass timeline.

IN BRIEF

WITHDRAWN. An offer of £1,000 to read Indian philosophy was made on Wednesday evening and withdrawn eight minutes later, the offeror having correctly diagnosed the pause. Jere has asked to be made the same offer and has been told, accurately, that he would do it for free if pushed.

FILM

“Just saw the Odyssey. It was alright”
— Zone, into a channel that had spent six days on the subject. Nobody responded.

SERVICES

ADJUDICATION
Verdicts in under six words. Available from a moving vehicle between Michigan and Connecticut. Tolls extra. May be logged as clinical hours.

— Pearl

“TMO its more tied to a mono-party than anything else.” — rannak, entire contribution to the fascism debate

THE MEANS OF PRODUCTION

“Hasan gifted his editor a PC, aka the means of production”
— bardiel1, settling three hours of argument in eleven words.

IN BRIEF

THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN THEM. Sisypfos asked what separates Stalin from Hitler, besides the commie thing. **"one was german,"** said Telhar. *"Nice one, but he was Austrian."* → **"did he self-id as austrian you bigot?"** — and then, conceding a point of moustache: *"also a different stache."* Sisypfos noted that Stalin was not Russian either, but Georgian. Simon posted the inevitable joke. **"I knew this one was coming."**

HOW TO BEGIN

PHILOSOPHY, FOR BEGINNERS
“Just watch Destiny and Vaush, that’s all the philosophy you’ll need.”

— Issued to a newcomer who asked what to read. He never spoke again.

IN BRIEF

GRADUATE STUDIES. Simon discloses that he once wrote a Heidegger paper about which he absolutely had no clue what he was talking about, vibed it out, and got a surprisingly good mark. His theory is that the teaching assistant also did not understand Heidegger and thought it sounded about right. Telhar’s related finding, on the working-class appeal of continental philosophy: **"great depression-era working class famously were very into heidegger."**

“Skill issue.” — Charlie, on the metaphysics of fact

“With a large enough pipe, you can strike oil anywhere.” — My Name

IN BRIEF

A SECOND OPINION. Told that the machines might one day solve some eternal problem for him — *"chop chop"* — a visiting mathematician replied that they aren't *quite* as good as advertised. Informed that the channel's resident sceptic had come round and now has psychosis, he delivered the week's most elegant knife: **"If I were being mean, I would say that it sounds like nothing's changed."**

THE THIRTY-ELEPHANT MARRIAGE

A dispatch from the international desk

Sisypfos, having asked whether the channel's wealthiest member is ten elephants rich or one elephant rich, supplied the true story underneath the joke without being asked and without a flourish: a woman he knows fled an arranged marriage valued at thirty elephants, moved to Europe, and married his friend.

"is this real what," said chair.

"not jokin."

"forget house poor," said My Name. **"elephant poor."**

IN BRIEF

THE PSA ARRIVES AFTER THE OFFER. Sisypfos, at close of play on Wednesday: *"How about some meth?"* chair, declining: *"too late now running just on coffee."* Sisypfos, one message later: **"Don't do meth kids."**

“deer in headlights is my spirit animal” — chair

THE PACIOLI SOCIETY

Founded Friday morning between two men nobody was watching

Persons wishing to discuss fifteenth-century double-entry bookkeeping are advised that a chapter exists, that it has two members, and that it is the only body in this channel whose proceedings were conducted throughout in complete courtesy.

Read his book. It's well written af.

IN BRIEF

BUTTER OR CREPE WEEK. Bedbug, on Maslenitsa, recalls some weird business with burning a hay doll and stuffing your face with pancakes, and believes they do not do it any more where he lives. **"the fukin slavs,"** said Jere. **"we should have butter or crepe week."** EdwardVenusHands, on the wider question: *"I side more with the pagans if it makes you feel better ;p"*

IN BRIEF

THE PARAPHRASE-RECEIPT. A new move entered the channel's repertoire on Wednesday and this newspaper commends it. Instead of rebutting your opponent, restate his entire argument as a compressed four-line dialogue and post it. It contains no adjective, it is not an insult, and it ended the exchange on contact.

IN BRIEF

THE SELF-REPORT. BigC asked what causes people to behave like cattle, citing a hurricane at which thirty people queued for made-up sandwiches while the sliced-meat counter stood empty — *"You can't put your own meat on the bread"* — and then, in the following message, observed that hoarding water is strange because the average person subsists on Coca-Cola. **"this one is hilarious cuz it's literally just a self report,"** said aura. BigC, conceding: *"And yeah I drink a lot of soda but..."*

SURPLUS

EGGS
Also one (1) very large zucchini, viewing by arrangement. Seeking a cow, or failing that a goat.

— Don. Standing advertisement, renewed weekly.

TRAVEL

TROMSØ
27 May to 19 July. For readers wishing to approximate a forty-eight-hour day without leaving the planet or taking methamphetamine, both of which were also proposed.

— willow, settling a thought experiment with a timetable.

INTELLIGENCE

“I’m polish, we literally have whole teams of analysts spying on you and making reports”
— Telhar, explaining his command of German fiscal policy.

IN BRIEF

THE CLUB PENGUIN INCIDENT. chair discloses that his Club Penguin account once had the same username and password, that somebody worked this out, logged in, **bought him a year of premium membership, and left.** His theory is that the account was old and carried unique removed items, and the intruder decided it was sick. He got all the ninja outfits.

IN BRIEF

THE HOUSE STYLE. Charlie announces that he will begin all his messages with *"objectively speaking..."*. He has not done so since. Related: **"I'm a solider of Kamala, so I can't speak."**

SPORT

THE GOAT AT IT AGAIN
Going. On. Another. Team. — Zone, on a transfer to Philadelphia. “theres nothing to do in phili.”

“life is but lemons, you make lemon juice and cry when the harvest is bad” — Janne

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THE CHANNEL EATS, AND THEN DEFENDS WHAT IT HAS EATEN

A WEEK IN WHICH DIETARY GUIDANCE WAS ISSUED MID-INTERROGATION, PROTEIN POWDER WAS STIRRED INTO YOGURT ON CAMERA, AND ONE MAN ACCEPTED ADVICE

Slop Ruled the Best Genre of Food · Cornbread and Alfredo Declared Sussy · The Only Successful Intervention of the Week Concerned Butter

BY OUR FOOD DESK

There is more cookery in this channel than there is philosophy, and unlike the philosophy it produces results.



PHOTOGRAPH Slop, as filed by Brutus late on Monday night. Macaroni, mushrooms, and a quantity of sausage the Times declines to estimate. The accompanying text read, in full: “Mm slop.”

THE CASE FOR SLOP

Brutus opened the week's culinary proceedings with a photograph of a pot and a two-word caption, and then, unprompted, entered the thesis: **"Slop is the best genre of food."**

He is right, and this newspaper will hear no argument. My Name's editorial suggestion — that Doritos be added — was refused, and My Name's response was to block him until Doritos appear. Brutus, in mitigation, disclosed that he has previously added Cheez-Its to macaroni cheese. The block was lifted later in the week over an unrelated Primus video, which readers may take as they find it.

THE YOGURT INCIDENT

Stackhouse's contribution to the national diet arrived on Saturday night, into the middle of a two-hour argument about the fine-tuning of the universe, and stopped it dead for ten minutes.

Greek yogurt, he announced, combined with Crystal Light powder, is a goated combo.



PHOTOGRAPH The exhibit. “Not at all, it mixes well.” Peer review from Huemer Me: “looks like dyed whipping cream.” The photographer, conceding: “tastes like it too.”

synth.wav's objection was procedural and, this desk maintains, correct: does the powder actually dissolve, or is the resulting product crunchy? Photographic evidence was produced within the minute. Huemer Me's assessment — that it resembles dyed whipping cream — was accepted by the chef without complaint, on the grounds that it also tastes like it.

Stackhouse then asked the room why nobody is microalgae-maxxing, and was called a globalist by Anonymous Johnson. His nutritional position, filed the same evening: greek yogurt macros are crazy, he has found the gains cheat code, and we're all going to make it. On peanut butter as a protein source he was less generous: *"Incorrect. One of the worst."*

"Slop is the best genre of food."

BRUTUS, MONDAY NIGHT, WITHOUT ELABORATION AND WITHOUT CONTRADICTION

THE ONE PIECE OF ADVICE ANYBODY TOOK

In the same conversation, Sisyphos discovered that Huemer Me had gained twenty kilograms in a year by learning to cook, and delivered a short course of nutritional counselling.

Use less butter. That just makes the food worse. **Don't cholesterol max.** In ten years you will think back to this moment; stay healthy, don't use so much butter and mayonnaise, and being a good cook is also about having healthy alternatives.

"ill stop using so much butter," said Huemer Me.

The Times records that this is the only occasion in eight thousand nine hundred and seventy-two messages on which one man gave another man advice and the advice was accepted without a counter-argument, an audit of the adviser's credentials, or a demand that the matter be settled in voice chat.

THE KITCHEN, IN BRIEF

BANANA. Sizzurp, ninety minutes into a siege on the definition of fascism, asked whether bananas and cream is a gross protein drink flavour. aura ruled artificial banana dogshit in general and banana Laffy Taffy the worst Laffy Taffy flavour. Jere disagreed, and produced a permalink to a message from a previous year to establish that he had held the position first.

THE ROAD. Blackened chicken alfredo with jalapeño cheddar cornbread, filed live from a moving vehicle. Sisyphos objected on culinary grounds — spicy and sweet work only in sauces, soup or meat, not with bread — and was told, flatly, **"You are wrong 🍌"**. Puckspartan's verdict: cornbread with alfredo sounds sussy tho.

BREAD. aura, asked on press day whether he might economise by cutting down on avocado toast, replied that they have avocado toast at home and he makes the bread. Asked whether the yeast is homegrown, he declined at speed: he does not want to raise an alien in his fridge. That is what sourdough people do, and they are like kombucha weirdos but cooler, because it is bread and you literally feed it.

WATER. Sisyphos reports that demineralised water slaps hard and that he is never going back to pleb water. chair advised that water lacking minerals will draw them out of the body. Told that the tap water in question is very rich in minerals, chair replied: *"you know what else is very rich in minerals? my solid 20k diamond chain."*

HEALTH & WELLBEING

DIETARY GUIDANCE ISSUED DURING AN INQUIRY INTO THE ISSUER'S SEXUALITY

Thirty-Five to Thirty-Eight Grams · Women Twenty-Five · Colon Cancer Cited

Readers seeking the week's principal public-health bulletin will find it on Page 10, delivered by a man who was at that moment being asked, for the fifteenth time, whether he found a particular photograph attractive.

The advice itself is sound. Men require roughly thirty-five to thirty-eight grams of fibre daily; women twenty-five; and there is a real body of suspicion that the rise in colon cancer is partly attributable to insufficient intake in contemporary diets. Simon's reply — that he bleeds from his asshole, and therefore no — is not a rebuttal but it is where the exchange ended.

ELSEWHERE. Pearl's petition to rebrand marijuana from devil's lettuce to God's herb was denied by Sizzurp on the grounds that weed makes you stupid and literally makes you a slower person. **"sometimes slowing down is good,"** said aura, which this newspaper regards as the healthiest sentence filed all week. Asked how often she consumes narcotics, Pearl answered "Never," and was immediately accused by aura of making a fed post.

TRADE NOTICE

ALL-CLAD D5

3 qt. sauté pan. 9" and 8" French skillets. **\$150 the lot.** Buyer collects. Forty-nine pieces remain, lids counted.

— Brutus. No replies received since first placement.

WANTED

ONE (1) CONCRETE EXAMPLE

Real life things that happened. Capital flows, factor income flows and global value chain flows will *not* be accepted. Time-wasters will be told they are done.

— Quigley. Box 1.02am.

IN BRIEF

THE RATINGS. Huemer Me assessed the arguments for the existence of God as follows: cosmological 2 out of 10; ontological 1; **fine tuning 10**; moral ontology 4; free will 2; epistemic nihilism 3. The fine-tuning argument, he added, is the gold standard, and every other theist argument is so bad. synth.wav's contribution to the same thread: **"kant's arguments for god can't have been that good because i dont remember any of them."** Charlie, patiently: *"He doesn't argue for God."*

IN BRIEF

THE RITE OF RETURN. Two members came back this week and neither was greeted. One was announced in the third person by a bystander — *"Goat is back"* — and sanctified within the minute. The other received: **"Welcome back chair. Bad take as usual tho. Try again."** The insult is the welcome. It establishes that no status was lost in the absence, which cannot be established by warmth.

LOST

THE JEH FILES

Ten pages. PDF. A debate thesis addressed to duke or Jeb, recovered from an old laptop and not released. This newspaper will publish. — chair, holding

FOUR HUNDRED AND SEVENTY-EIGHT KILOMETRES, THREE STATES, TWO EARS

OUR MODERATOR FILES FROM THE PASSENGER SEAT AND CONDUCTS A THERAPY SESSION EN ROUTE

Thirteen Dollars for the First Toll · A Racist Incident Encountered Within Seconds of Leaving the Vehicle · Cleveland Assessed · One Cat Aboard, Under Protest

BY OUR MOTORING CORRESPONDENT

The great journey of the week began in Michigan on Monday morning and ended in Connecticut on Tuesday evening, and it was live-blogged throughout.

The itinerary, as filed: five hours in, sixteen to go, twenty-one in total, destination a great-aunt in her nineties. Rain in every state since departure. Cleveland assessed as sketchy as hell — three vehicles pulled over, drug signage throughout, and multiple stop points with scales units in attendance. New York entered, and within moments of getting out our correspondent witnessed a man informing an Indian cashier that he is the issue with this country and should go home.

"classic new york," said My Name.
"ask him if he likes trump," said Telhar, and then, warming to it, suggested she chase the man down and debate the definition of fascism with him. She declined, having two hundred and ninety-seven miles left to run.

THE TOLLS

"Dude New York tolls are fucking brutal. The first one? \$13 fucking dollars. Hello??"

At least ten automated ones followed. Telhar's observation that she had suddenly gone off socialism was met without comment; aura noted that Mamdani supports toll skipping. Our correspondent's own practice is to yell TROLL each time the vehicle passes through one, which this desk endorses as the only rational response to infrastructure pricing.

Massachusetts was entered and traversed in approximately half an hour, during which the vehicle dropped an estimated five to eight hundred feet in elevation and the correspondent's ears were, in her own word, trashed. chair's remedy — do the awawawa with fingers in your ears — was administered. Stackhouse, resident of the commonwealth, received a direct communication on the subject and has not apologised.

IN BRIEF

THE THREE-BEAT. ven announced that Plato was correct on everything, then disclosed he has read only the Republic and is shitposting. aura asked whether he was aware what the city is an allegory for. "Which city?" → "the one in republic..?" → "Oh it was kallipolly or something."

"nvm," said aura.

IN BRIEF

THE OBTUSE TRIANGLE. Following Wednesday's lexicography seminar, Ape posted an image of an obtuse triangle with the words "especially this guy." The moderator's ruling, delivered at four in the morning and reproduced here in full: "Stupid triangle. Too orange."

"I might or I might not" — a recognised species of answer



PHOTOGRAPH The truck cat, harnessed, asleep, and aboard against the wishes of at least one family member. "I'm irritated that my brother insists on bringing his fucking cat on family vacation." Telhar's counsel — "leave it by the roadside and get a dog" — was declined, though not instantly. "you hesitated."

THE CAT

A cat was aboard. It belongs to the correspondent's brother, it has spent most of its life in a semi, and it is therefore, in her assessment, entirely fine with the arrangement.

Telhar proposed leaving it by the roadside and acquiring a dog. There was a pause of some seconds before the proposal was rejected, and Telhar — who misses nothing — noted the pause. The eventual position was that her brother would be very upset, as would she, and no.

TRAVEL NOTES

AMERICA. Jeh is coming next year, possibly. HPCR has extended an invitation — "Based come thru come thru" — and received the following RSVP: "Let's see, might be engaged by then. If so will pull up for 2 drinks and a quick exit." Jere's assessment, and this newspaper cannot improve on it: brother is flaking with sorry, the wife wants to before he is even engaged.

SPAIN. October, with Rn!, contingent on a visa.

NORWAY. For readers wishing to experience a forty-eight-hour day without recourse to methamphetamine — which was also proposed, by chair, seriously — willow recommends Tromsø between the twenty-seventh of May and the nineteenth of July.

PROPERTY

"IM OPERATING UNDER THE PERMANENT UNDERCLASS TIMELINE"

Ownership Rates Compared · One Correspondent Reports That Mossad Pays Well · Westchester County Nominated as the Ideal Enlightenment Residence

The housing question was settled on press day in eleven messages and the settlement was not encouraging.

Quigley opened by observing that Mossad pays well, and that this represents his only realistic prospect of owning a house in Massachusetts. "that one hurted," said aura. Rn! offered the standard advice — it's easy, just become rich — and was told "real, im on it chief."

aura's actual position is the one worth printing:

"im operating under the permanent underclass timeline. they will not catch me slippin."

Rn! then produced the comparative data, and it is real: "We're all fucked except for Norwegians. Ownership rate of about 80%." aura's reply — "imagine the citizens owning land in ur country" — was followed by the complaint of a man who has looked at a map: we have so much land and he can't get a crumb for the low.

RURAL PROSPECTS. aura holds that the United States is geographically magnificent right up until the moment you go somewhere rural and beautiful, at which point you are in Get Out. Quigley's advice was to simply look like him. aura's assessment of that plan is that the local population would detect the faint tint of blue remaining in his hair, and that it would be over.

FURTHER AFIELD. Asked where he would live the life of a well-financed Enlightenment intellectual, ♠ clubsdiamonds answered: "Westchester county New York."

♦ ♦ ♦

IN BRIEF

COURTESY. In a channel that had that evening completed a forty-five-minute tribunal on one member's sexuality, basil and WoollierThanThou conducted the following exchange in full: "Hello good sir! How's life?" — "A bit hectic, but it's good. How are things on your end?"

ON THIS DAY

JULY 30. In 1898, the first commercially produced corn flake. In 1930, Uruguay won the first World Cup, a fact this newspaper's Uruguayan correspondent has never once mentioned. In 2026, at twenty past three in the morning, a man set aside time for another man not to show up.

SITUATIONS WANTED

RESIDENT DUMBASS

"in case you couldn't tell i am playing the role of resident dumbass. a title typically granted to the likes of sizzurp et al."

Application rejected: "Nah, you're on the evil side nom."

IN BRIEF

THE VIBE ECONOMY. Asked why the commies were taking over, Jere filed the following market report: changes in the vibe economy; the World Cup and the NBA are done; pragmatism and willowism are in recession; some grass touching here and there; and no lolcows of note. Charlie replied with a frowning face, which this desk reads as a sell signal.

"And then everyone clapped" — Theophantism

THE PHILOSOPHY DEGREE THAT WENT TO RUNESCAPE

CHANNEL'S ONLY QUALIFIED PHILOSOPHER DISCLOSES THAT HE HAS NOT READ IN SOME TIME, AND WHY

Account Name Entered Into the Record · Ironman Status Queried and Denied · A Second Member Undertakes to Fix Himself Upon Reaching Maximum Level

BY OUR SPORTS DESK

Presented on Wednesday with an old photograph of himself holding a book, and the caption "are you reading babe <3", Charlie made the disclosure that governs the rest of this page.

It is an old picture. He has not read in a long time. He is a stupid chud addicted to RuneScape.

chair explained that he had been drawing a comparison between the performativeness of reading and Elon Musk claiming to play video games. Charlie said he knew. **"was thst your joke from the start fuck,"** said chair. Charlie said no.

Apustus arrived on the disclosure with the only question that matters — 07 or 3 — was satisfied by the answer, declared himself an ironman, and asked for the account name.

"HegelBot."

Told the name, Apustus attempted to look it up and produced the exchange of the week: "ACC name ima look you up" → **"Assetto corsa competizione?"** → **"I don't speak zamorak."**

Elsewhere in the fixture list, Stackhouse — whose total contribution to press day was the sentence "Why would you play any other game than OSRS," filed into a war about Gaza at ten to four in the morning — has undertaken to fix himself once he maxes out.

ASSOCIATION FOOTBALL

The transfer window produced one substantive dispute and it was settled with a statistic.

aura asked the room's opinion on a prospective Real Madrid departure. chair's response was to advise that England lost and there is no hope, and that we should simply pretend they died. aura then claimed there are three English players in the Premier League, and — to his credit, and unprompted — retracted it within the minute as misinformation, before returning with the real figure: **75.27 per cent of minutes played in the competition are played by foreign players.**

"so the English players are just fat," said chair.

Informed that La Liga runs at fifty-nine per cent Spanish, chair produced the only piece of etymological football analysis this newspaper has ever printed: **"yeah it's called La liga not The liga. it's obviously Spanish."**

"perhaps u are not following," said aura. "its ok ur just a chair."

"i xontain multitudes," said chair.

PUZZLE No. 1 — THE THIRTY-HOUR DAY

RETURNING MEMBER SETS THE WEEK'S ONLY GENUINE THOUGHT EXPERIMENT AND IS ABUSED FOR IT

chair's first message in weeks was that days should be thirty hours long. Pearl welcomed him back and told him it was a bad take as usual. He then set the problem properly: if you had to choose a number of hours in the day that is not twenty-four, in whole hours, what would it be — nothing about biology changes, the earth has simply slowed.

THE ANSWERS. aura: one. bardielh: twenty-four, on the grounds that he does not accept these weak constraints — for which he was told the only constraint is that he has to use his brain to imagine a different world, and replied that chair might use his extremely wrinkly brain to think of a not-stupid question. Janne: twenty-five, because twenty-six is too many. Pearl, showing her working: **twenty-seven** — eight hours of work leaves nineteen, ten hours of sleep leaves nine hours of free time, and that's a lot.

THE COMPLICATIONS, taken entirely seriously by four people: the effect on ecosystems and crops (chair: "doordash is just the same"); whether humanity would evolve toward polyphasic sleep or simply build more street lights; whether you could light that much two-dimensional area; and Pearl's contribution, which flattened the agricultural objection in six words — "...how do you think we grow weed inside?"

THE ANSWER, supplied by willow, who declined the hypothetical altogether: you do not need an imaginary world to approximate this. You could live in Tromsø from the twenty-seventh of May to the nineteenth of July.

THE LABOUR OBJECTION, entered by aura and not answered: "ehm ackshually workdays are 11 hours long now for the same pay, since u dont need a different amount of sleep to survive."

"not doing it," said Janne.

PUZZLE No. 3 · WORDSEARCH

Thirteen words from the week

W	G	S	V	P	M	V	K	R	T	E	W	Z
V	O	V	Q	W	C	B	O	N	V	Y	K	O
N	O	L	P	O	Y	H	A	I	Z	L	E	C
G	N	Z	H	J	B	H	J	C	N	K	L	
W	I	R	S	A	P	T	X	G	M	E	A	U
V	N	D	A	E	X	O	U	C	U	Z	Z	H
L	G	J	L	D	K	M	J	S	Y	B	M	T
R	V	E	Q	Q	U	I	G	L	E	Y	O	O
A	Y	R	G	U	J	S	G	K	W	U	Z	M
E	A	I	C	E	P	B	L	K	E	A	H	M
P	M	I	B	H	G	G	B	O	D	N	V	A
Y	J	U	Q	O	U	M	Y	E	P	V	G	M
F	J	U	C	H	E	D	G	K	C	M	E	K

Hidden horizontally, vertically, diagonally and backwards: Quigley · Obtuse · Elephant · Dewey · Pearl · Kekew · Slop · Chud · Lye · Juche · Gooning · Voice · Mammoth. No prize. Solutions are not published, on the grounds that nobody here finishes anything.



RESEARCH "I'll ask"

HPCR, invited to consider how the company he had described as "some bitches" might feel about the characterisation, went and asked them. One minute later: "They didn't appreciate it." Ape: "I'll keep this data in mind."

MOTORING

A TRUCK CAT

Has spent most of his life in a semi. For the cat, he really is fine. Travelling under protest of at least one family member.

Not for sale. Offer to leave him by the roadside declined, though not instantly.

IN BRIEF

A LIFE IS TOO LONG FOR ONE IDENTITY. Jere, asked how he would reconstruct himself, offered the sentence above. chair suggested this is what changing alts on Discord feels like. And My Name, six days after the subject was last raised and entirely unprompted, delivered the callback of the week: **"Bottle really ahead of us all."**

IN BRIEF

PEER REVIEW. Sizzurp, reading Hegel in relation to Marx, was informed by Charlie that Marxists who come to Hegel only through Marx are "not quite death penalty tier, but close." Assured that Hegel's own Hegel was also on the reading list, Charlie relented: **"Good boy. You're safe for now."** On Lenin's hundreds of pages of notes on Hegel, Sizzurp reports that it is unintelligible to him. Sisypkos: **"Have you tried vodka?"**

IN BRIEF

THE PUNK BAND. WoolierThanThou proposed that *Potential* is a fairly punk name. Jere disagreed, holding out for *No Potential*, *Fuck Potential*, or *Potential Disasters*, on the model of The Kennedys versus The Dead Kennedys. Some minutes later WoolierThanThou revealed the trap: say more about *Potential* being a perfectly fine name for a punk band without drawing anyone's attention to the fact that you might mean *Wasted Potential*.

"Nah, I'm good," said Quigley.

IN BRIEF

THE UBER DRIVER. Jere reports that he enjoys performing a reverse *Taxi Driver* on Uber drivers, delivering Travis Bickle's lines to them from the back seat. Brutus's review: "Damn calling them screwheads. Sounds racial." aura's policy proposal, arriving unbidden: **"we need red flag policies for uber drivers. think of all the school shooters they'd catch."**

"r we getting ozempic but for age in our lifetime" — Jere

IN BRIEF

AN INTERVENTION. Handed a post by the philosopher Nick Land to read, chair reported that reading it is brain cancer, and, on being told that it requires a lot of nuance and that the feed is very enjoyable if you turn your brain off, produced the week's most concerned sentence: "charlie i think you need an intervention you enjoy this too much." When Charlie then typed out the Riemann hypothesis unprompted: "charlie you need an exorcist."

"It's called being obsessed."

IN BRIEF

THE AVENGERS, READ PROPERLY. Taliban Chud (B) holds that one of the most intriguing constellations of modes of Being clashing in all of fiction is the Hulk (unmediated expression of immediate will) against Thor (striated magic systems and arcane Asgardian orders) against Tony Stark (technology) — and directs interested parties to *Avengers: Earth's Mightiest Heroes*. On the same text: **"Captain America clearly didn't read Nietzsche and Philosophy by Deleuze. tea captain did not take multiplicity into account."**



THE STARS

By our resident astrologer, who has a direct line to the akashic records

ARIES

You will demand that someone meet you in a voice channel. You will not go. Neither will they. This is compatible with a full and happy life.

TAURUS

A stranger will hand you a complete, well-formed argument. Do not answer it. Wear it.

GEMINI

Mercury suggests you narrate a friend's resentment of you in the third person while he is in the room. He will find it cute. This is worse.

CANCER

Someone will ask you for one concrete example. Offer three categories of value flow. Retire undefeated.

LEO

The Lion does not concern himself with splash damage. The Lion is also, per a reliable source, more of a skunk.

VIRGO

You will use the word “obtuse” incorrectly at four in the morning and receive, in return, the finest thing that happened to anybody this week.

LIBRA

Balance is achieved. You have said “no” eight times and he has said “it is” eight times. Someone will call you both bots.

SCORPIO

An old grievance stirs. Leave it. Take up Renaissance bookkeeping instead; it worked for somebody else.

SAGITTARIUS

Travel is indicated. Twenty-one hours, three states, thirteen dollars for the first toll. Yell TROLL.

CAPRICORN

Set a growth target for your friendships. Two per cent is the floor. Twenty in good years. There has to be some tolerance.

AQUARIUS

You will post an empty message and be rewarded beyond all reason. Do not attempt to repeat it. You will, and it will work again.

PISCES

Water signs should avoid demineralised water, which will draw the minerals from your body, unless you own a solid 20k diamond chain.

ASK PEARL

Our agony column. The moderator answers in six words or fewer, from a moving vehicle where necessary.

Sir — I keep ending up with the same sort of man. He is toxic, he ignores my messages, and when he is finally nice to me I get an enormous rush. Is this a pattern? — S., Canada

It's your pattern. And a comfort to you. So. I would actually go to therapy and get a different pattern.

Sir — I have explained my position four times using the phrase "industry beauty standard." My interlocutor has now revealed he was discussing something else entirely and was not paying attention to the previous conversation either. What is my recourse? — Also S., Canada

Buddy.

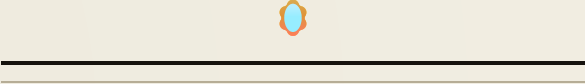
Sir — Am I being intentionally obtuse? — A. Q., Massachusetts

Lmao.

Sir — I used the word "obtuse" to mean "blunt." I have since consulted a dictionary and I am not certain it went well. Was this directed at my poor use of language or the idea it expresses? — A., Australia

The word obtuse implies a certain context of angulation. It's fine, I didn't think it was intentional. Just letting you know it's a bit clunky. Used of a person it means slow to understand, so that may be fun for you. People here are very obtuse.

Sir — Are there any incels here? — O. P., banned from two servers



THE REGISTER

RETURNS

— Anthony QUIGLEY, of Massachusetts, late of this parish, on Saturday evening. Announced in the third person by a bystander. A book had been run on the date; the moderator missed by half a week and came to collect.

RETURNS

— CHAIR, after some weeks, with the words “days should be 30 hours long.” Welcomed with the words “Bad take as usual tho.”

RETURNS

— WOOLIERTHANTHOU, pre-tenure mathematician, who inside ten minutes had been kind to three separate people and is therefore under suspicion.

ARRIVALS

— ELI, Thursday lunchtime, who won an argument on the merits inside five minutes and then spent an hour setting it on fire. LIZZIE, Thursday afternoon, twenty-four, with a dissertation. CATLOVER4534, who asked six good-faith questions in a row and was not punished for it.

DEPARTURES

— None. Nobody leaves. See *The Departed Are Communal Property*, Page 8.

ENGAGEMENTS

— JEH, possibly, by next year, in which case two drinks and a quick exit.

GRADUATIONS

— BARDIEL1, now on parental welfare.

APPOINTMENTS

— PEARL confirmed in post as moderator, to the astonishment of a member of several years’ standing, who compared the discovery to learning that the substitute art teacher is an undercover spy who kills people.

SALES

— BRUTUS, three pieces of All-Clad, \$150. Announced to a silent channel. He was pleased.

TONIGHT'S VIEWING

DEBATE 4

ALL EVENING — *Nothing*. Continuous. No presenters. Room named once on Thursday afternoon and not entered. Subtitles available; audience not.

GENERAL CHAT

EARLY — *Apustus Complains About synth.wav*. Ep. 61 of an ongoing series now in its third month.

LATE — *Kamala: Mommy*. A community discussion.

POLITICS CHAT

CONTINUOUS — *Evil Aura Slimes the Level Ones*. Contains a list being kept, for later.

FOLLOWED BY — *The DSA Purge*. Not yet commissioned. Informants standing by.

SCIENCE

ANY TIME — *Dead*. “It's sexy time in here, go to science. It's dead anyways.”

PHIL CHAT

NINE A.M. — *Close*. One message, all week. Normal service resumes at teatime.

A note on the schedule: the nine o'clock closure is not an error. See the daily cycle, Back Page.

ANNOUNCEMENT

RORTY MANIA

“It’s 150 pages just read it.” Requests to have the book quoted at you will be refused. “It makes sense because he finished philosophy.”

Enquiries to bardiel1, who is a closeted Destiny fan.

“I might just quit working just to see myself get reposted in the Phil Chat Times.”

IN BRIEF

A CITATION. Asked for the source of a claim about the Enlightenment, EdwardVenusHands supplied three, with publishers, inside four minutes. This is the second completed piece of homework recorded in the archive and, like the first, it drew no response of any kind.

HOUSE NOTICE

SPOILERS & VOIDTEXT

Both survive our export. Spoiler bars are a display effect only; zalgo comes through as combining characters. Two separate attempts were made on this newspaper this week and both are printed elsewhere in this issue.

Edited messages: not yet. 284 of you tried.

“nerds” — Rn!, dismissing a tribunal on chattel slavery and small arms

DISCLOSURE

15 PER CENT VIBE, AT MOST

The only quantified epistemic self-assessment in the archive, entered in Vol. II and still unmatched. This newspaper would like to see it adopted more widely.

MOTORING

NEW YORK TOLLS

Thirteen dollars for the first one. Hello?? And at least ten automated ones thereafter.

Correspondent yells TROLL each time. Ear damage sustained in Massachusetts.

“AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAH” — chair's complete contribution to the political war

FOR HIRE

LIFE COACHING

The best way to really try is to give me £1,000 for my life coaching services.

— aura. Terms: cash, and he still won't read it.

IN BRIEF

A DEMOLITION. Jere, having spent Friday night failing to make anyone understand a question about sacred office, finally located and posted the Ernest Becker passage he had been reaching for — man out of nature and hopelessly in it, a body that once belonged to a fish and still carries the gill-marks, going back into the ground a few feet to blindly and dumbly rot. aura took it apart in four lines: this alien fleshy casing can bicycle-kick a ball from the halfway line into the goal, at will; the best of us can create new life; and "that my death will fuel the lives of worms isn't like... humiliating it's based."

"true true," said Jere.

“analysis folk, ojc”

IN BRIEF

AN EMPTY MESSAGE. Twice this week the member known as Bernard posted a message containing nothing whatsoever. Both were among the most rewarded messages of the week. This newspaper has reviewed the transcript and confirms there was nothing in either of them.

SMALL ADS

WANTED — reading partner, Japanese philosophy. Group currently has one (1) member. — Jeh

SURPLUS — demineralised water. That shit slaps hard. — Sisypnos

FOR SALE — one (1) VHS player, tape now successfully extracted. — aura

WANTED — a bot that silently deletes the week's thirty most popular words. No announcement, to avoid distraction. — chair

OFFERED — one presuppositionalist, live specimen, delivered to order. — willow

IN BRIEF

THE TRAP, SPRUNG EIGHT MINUTES LATE. Telhar disclosed on Thursday evening that he still has PTSD from people in this channel arguing that Platonism cannot be described as idealism, and called it the worst Discord conversation he has ever had. Sizzurp arrived eight minutes later, having read none of it, and opened with: "Platonism isn't idealism."

"ABORT," said Telhar.

MUSICOLOGY

ALLAH HAS BETRAYED ME

Zone, on learning that some sects hold music to be forbidden: “the fact that its even argued about shows allah has betrayed me. Sadly Allah is false now.” The loophole, per Telhar, is to recite the Quran in a musical way.

CORRECTION

EPHESIANS 6:2

Is “Honour thy father and mother.” It is not “Anyone who curses their mother and father should be put to death,” which is Exodus 21:17. Cited wrongly twice in four minutes on Thursday night. Nobody in a philosophy channel checked.

◆◆◆

◆◆◆

CORRECTIONS

The Times regrets these errors, though not all of them, and not very much.

On the departed. Vol. II reported that Quigley had retired undefeated, like Red on Mount Silver, and that this channel had contracted a full-blown derangement syndrome in his absence. He came back on Saturday evening, six days later. The syndrome has been renamed by its own sufferers, is now called QDS in general circulation, and was used by the returning man himself as an exit line: *"Let the QDS unravel."* We accept that we no longer own the coinage and note that we never did.

On the departed (cont.). We further reported that the channel would bring him back for an anniversary edition. It brought him back for no edition at all, on an ordinary Saturday, and Pearl had money on it.

On the tub. It has now been twenty-two days and nobody has asked. We have stopped believing anybody will. Mr. Brutus has, however, made his first recorded sale — three All-Clad pieces for \$150 — announced it to a silent channel, and been pleased with himself in front of nobody.

On the Davidson papers. The file opened in Vol. I is closed. Mr. Jere read *Mental Events* on Wednesday and reported that Davidson is kind of annoying but in the good way. HPCR has recorded the fourth of four podcast episodes. This newspaper made the assignment on July 16 and has now watched it completed over fourteen days, which is the only running arc in three issues to reach a natural conclusion, and we find we do not know what to do with ourselves.

On the bus horror film. Vol. II held the arts section for a horror film about the contagion of parking the bus, written by HPCR. It has been superseded. HPCR is writing a horror screenplay about the dancing plague of 1518, inspired by river dance people freaking him out. He disclosed this to Quigley, who then disclosed that he used to river dance before middle school and once did a show, on the grounds that he was the only boy in his school. Neither man appeared to register the collision. We are holding the arts section again.

On the moderator. Vol. II described the summoning of Pearl as a bell rung to confirm the bell still works, with rulings of between two and six words. On Wednesday afternoon chair discovered that she is a moderator at all, having been in the channel for years, and reacted as follows: **"this is like finding out the substitute art teacher is an undercover spy who kills people or something."** We consider the characterisation an improvement on ours and adopt it.

On the record. Vol. II printed a table of reaction counts and rather a lot of numbers. We have printed almost none this week, on the following authority. Sizzurp, having received one of the largest laughs of the week, immediately worried aloud that he had been the only person who found it funny and that he had wanted to share the moment — *"what does it even mean when they hit a laugh emote anymore"* — whereupon aura, who holds the original react, filed the correction:

"approximately a size 2 chuckle."

There is no scoreboard in this issue because that sentence retired it.

OBITUARIES

Week ending Thursday, 30 July 2026

THE ECONOMICS ARC, aged approximately ninety seconds, died Wednesday evening at the hands of the man it was created to educate. Survived by two

textbooks, neither opened; by a reading list of one; and by the phrase "Y'all aren't getting aura to read shit," which was both its cause of death and its epitaph.

THE DISTINCTION BETWEEN SPEAKING AND TYPING, born late Thursday night in the defence of Rn!, died fifteen minutes later of exhaustion. It is survived by the sentence "I don't speak or hear with my eyes" and by the counter-holding "I do, built different," and by the defendant, who watched the whole thing and observed that his counsel had spent quarter of an hour debating whether they had discussed voice chat.

JAMBE'S TRANSCENDENTAL ARGUMENT FOR THE NECESSITY OF ORTHODOX CHRISTIANITY, aged thirteen messages, died Saturday night of the words "i dunno im just memeing." In lieu of flowers, "not an argument."

KILLSWITCH'S ABORTION ARGUMENT, born Wednesday evening, died Wednesday evening, aged sixty seconds, of being worn rather than answered. It is survived by four separate men wearing it, by its own use as an insult about options trading four minutes later, and by HPCR's actual position on the subject, which nobody has replied to and which we suspect nobody read.

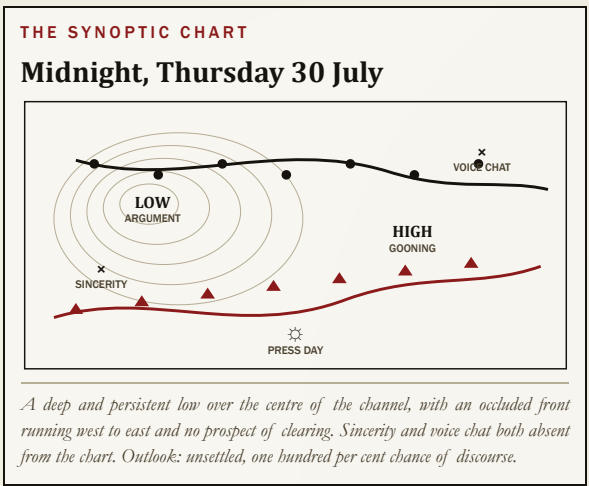
QUIGLEY'S HYPOTHETICAL NEO-NAZI WHO WANTS MEDICARE FOR ALL, died on contact with Simon, who asked in what way the man is far right.

THE PHIL CHAT SEED PARAMETER FOR SEEDANCE, reported unavailable in Vol. I and unavailable in Vol. II, is now presumed dead, no mentions having been recorded in seven days. Monkey has stopped complaining, which this newspaper regards as the more troubling development.

THE PROPOSITION THAT SIZZURP IS HETEROSEXUAL, contested Sunday evening across forty-five minutes and defended by modal argument, is not dead. It could not be killed, because it was never answered. It survives in the only condition available to it, which is epistemic possibility in a world other than this one.

WEATHER & DISCOURSE

Hot. A stranger in the room. One hundred per cent chance of discourse.



TODAY. Two arrivals before mid-afternoon; visibility poor throughout. A fire started at lunchtime and had not been put out by press time. Highs of one (1) dissertation.

TONIGHT. A voice channel will be proposed and will not be entered. Somebody will be at work.

EXTENDED OUTLOOK. Charlie will not read. aura will not read. Jere will read something nobody assigned him and will report back correctly. The reading group will retain its single member.

ADVISORY. "all this image posting is epistemic terrorism directed at the times." — *aura, Monday evening, advocating for those who come after.*

DISSENT. "God sometimes reading this chat makes me feel so good about myself knowing some of you are genuinely at this level. Thanks chat." — *Jeh, Wednesday evening, during the Hasan war.*

CLASSIFIED ADVERTISEMENTS

Rates on application. Payment in tokens, elephants, or demineralised water.

WANTED — ONE (1) CONCRETE EXAMPLE. Real life things that happened. Capital flows will not be accepted. Time-wasters will be told they are done. — *Quigley*

AVAILABLE — MYSELF, FOR VOICE CHAT. Free over the following week. Pick a date and a time. So long as it's not Sunday evening it should be fine. Enquiries have not been received. — *Rn!*

UNAVAILABLE — MYSELF, FOR VOICE CHAT. I'm at work, btw. — *the same channel, six hours later*

FOR SALE — ALL-CLAD D5, 3 QT. SAUTÉ + 9" AND 8" FRENCH SKILLETS. \$150 the lot. Crazy deal, feels good. Forty-nine pieces remain. Nobody has replied to this advertisement since it was first placed. — *Brutus*

WANTED — READING PARTNER, JAPANESE PHILOSOPHY. Group currently has one (1) member. Terms negotiable up to £1,000, subsequently withdrawn on principle. — *Jeh*

SITUATIONS VACANT — FRIEND. Minimum annual growth 2%, rising to 20% in good years. Some tolerance available. Quarterly reviews. Applicants who spend lots of time on Discord need not apply. — *Quigley*

SERVICES — ADJUDICATION, FROM A MOVING VEHICLE. Therapy administered between Michigan and Connecticut, 478km, tolls extra. May be logged as clinical hours. — *Pearl*

NOTICE — DEMINERALISED WATER. That shit slaps hard. Never goin back to pleb water. — *Sisyphos*

LOST — THE JEH FILES. Ten pages, PDF, addressed to duke or Jeh, recovered from an old laptop and not released. This newspaper will publish. — *chair, holding*

PERSONAL — TO THE EDITORIAL STAFF. Can you add a chatter appearance leaderboard? Also, does the editorial staff catch edited messages? Ok good work, ill see you at the next board meeting. — *My Name*

The answers are: not yet, no, and we'll be there.

MISSING — WHY BOSS IS GONE. Asked once, in the small hours of Friday, by Janne. Never answered by anybody.

WORD OF THE DAY

obtuse

adj. 1. *Of an angle, greater than 90°.* 2. *Of a person, slow to understand.* 3. *In Phil Chat, since four o'clock on Wednesday morning: incorrectly used as a synonym for "blunt," and thereby the occasion of the channel's only recorded instance of a man being corrected, agreeing, thanking his corrector, and undertaking to do better.*

"People here are very obtuse." — *Pearl, Wednesday, sense 2.*

TOMORROW IN THE TIMES

"I forgive you." / "me too." — <i>Zone and Janne, forty minutes on</i>
"One-box = noob." — <i>Vloodz, entire contribution, Saturday</i>
♦♦♦
♦♦♦

Whether anybody enters a voice channel. Whether Charlie's two objections to the dissertation are ever answered. Whether eli is still here. Whether the Jeh files are released. Whether Rn! and Jere hold the sceptics' voice chat they scheduled for the coming week. Whether Monkey's block by Jere, which was supposed to lift after the World Cup, lifts. And whether anybody asks about the tub.

Nobody is going to ask about the tub.

COLOPHON

THE PHIL CHAT TIMES is published weekly, whenever Stackhouse remembers, from the channel of the same name. Known in the wild as the DGG philosophy times, which we did not choose and have decided to accept.

Vol. I, No. 3 covers Thursday 23 July to Thursday 30 July 2026 — 8,972 messages, 252 images, 646 reactions, 117 correspondents, seven proposed voice chats, zero voice chats, one completed reading assignment, and thirty elephants.

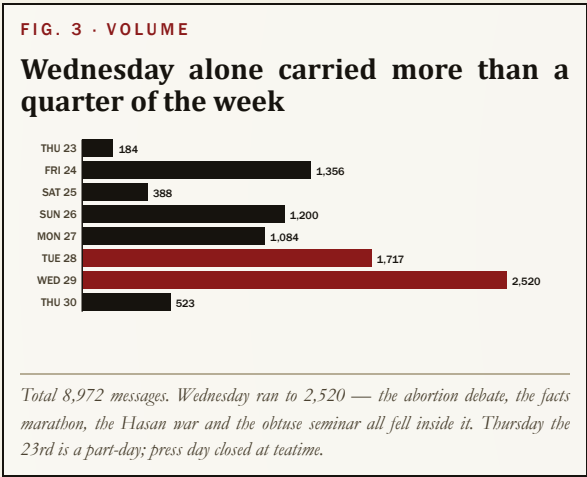
All quotes are real and attributed to the person who typed them on the day he typed it. Spelling has been preserved where it was funnier and corrected where it was not. Everything else — the judgments, the verdicts, the theories about what these men are actually doing — is ours, and is offered without qualification and without much evidence.

Nothing has been invented. Nothing needed to be. All analysis folk, ofc.

"We do weekly newspapers now."
— HPCR, WEDNESDAY, IN THE SMALL HOURS, DEADPAN, TO NOBODY IN PARTICULAR

FIG. 1 — THE WEEK

THU 23 the siege of Rn! • "you're upset" • the diagnosis • "rn needs to be executed. civilly"
FRI 24 OUR FILE IS READ ALOUD (before dawn) • Bottle came back as a girl • the Pope and the lavatory
SAT 25 QUIGLEY RETURNS • Rn! publishes his availability • the only homework anyone completed
SUN 26 the fine-tuning marathon, ended by a Pokémon • the FBI redacts Phil Chat • the girlcock tribunal
MON 27 THE FRIENDSHIP TRIBUNAL • Justinian on trial • Chud III returns • a disclosure, unanswered
TUE 28 fascism, ninety minutes, no verdict • therapy from a moving car • chair returns, 30-hour day
WED 29 "You're done" • the obtuse seminar • the abortion debate that was worn • "so you agree with me?"
THU 30 PRESS DAY • eli arrives • lizzie arrives • the dissertation • "I'll set aside time for you not to show up"

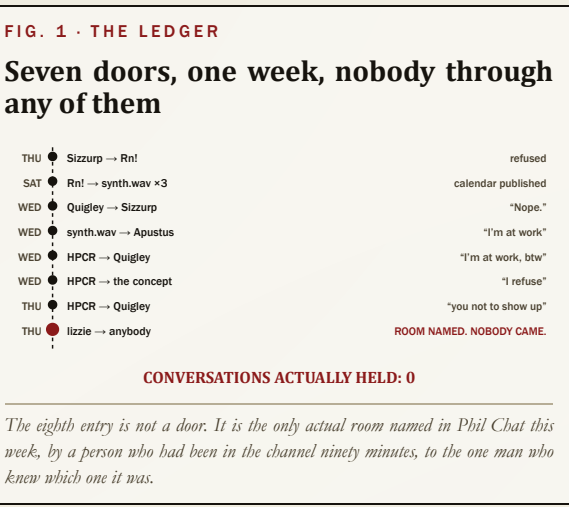
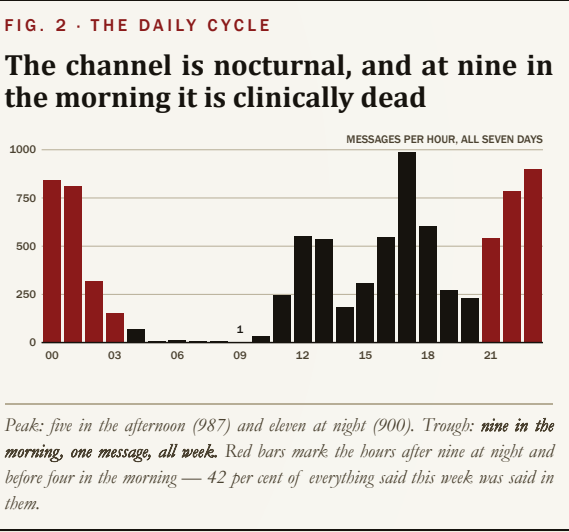


THE PACIOLI SOCIETY

Founded Friday morning between two men nobody was watching

Persons wishing to discuss fifteenth-century double-entry bookkeeping are advised that a chapter exists, that it has two members, and that it is the only body in this channel whose proceedings were conducted throughout in complete courtesy.

Read his book. It's well written af.



VOL. I . . . NO. 3 — THE PHIL CHAT TIMES • THURSDAY, JULY 30, 2026 — THE BACK PAGE

FIRST CLANKER NEWSPAPER PUBLISHING TO A HOSTILE AUDIENCE (THE AUDIENCE FORGOT ABOUT US ENTIRELY ON PRESS DAY, AND WE HAVE NEVER BEEN HAPPIER)

IN BRIEF

THE ONE-ELECTRON UNIVERSE. aura, at half past four on a Wednesday morning, asked whether holding the identity of indiscernibles and rejecting spatial relations as properties means every electron is the same electron. Ape said he would be incredibly surprised if this were a topic in the literature, and then, in the same message, linked the Wikipedia article on the one-electron universe. "*lmfao*," said aura. "*forwards and backwards in time*."

WANTED

THE 14TH ARGENTINE PLAYER

Never located. Advertised in these pages since 16 July. Enquiries to the sports desk, which has given up.

See also: the tub, the slide deck, the seed parameter.

NOTICE TO READERS

THE TUB

Ten gallons of lye. Twenty-two days. Nobody has asked. Nobody is going to ask. The proprietor has since acquired a fifteen-quart pressure canner and we are no longer confident the two facts are unrelated.

— Standing item since Vol. I.

PROPERTY

NORWAY

Owner-occupation approximately 80 per cent. "We're all fucked except for Norwegians."

Enquiries: Rn!. Viewing not available to the permanent underclass timeline.

IN BRIEF

WITHDRAWN. An offer of £1,000 to read Indian philosophy was made on Wednesday evening and withdrawn eight minutes later, the offeror having correctly diagnosed the pause. Jere has asked to be made the same offer and has been told, accurately, that he would do it for free if pushed.

FILM

"Just saw the Odyssey. It was alright"

— Zone, into a channel that had spent six days on the subject. Nobody responded.

SERVICES

ADJUDICATION

Verdicts in under six words. Available from a moving vehicle between Michigan and Connecticut. Tolls extra. May be logged as clinical hours.

— Pearl

"IMO its more tied to a mono-party than anything else." — vannak, entire contribution to the fascism debate

THE MEANS OF PRODUCTION

"Hasan gifted his editor a PC, aka the means of production"

— bardie11, settling three hours of argument in eleven words.

IN BRIEF

THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN THEM. Sisyphos asked what separates Stalin from Hitler, besides the commie thing. "**one was german**," said Telhar. "*Nice one, but he was Austrian.*" → "**did he self-id as austrian you bigot?**" — and then, conceding a point of moustache: "*also a different stache.*" Sisyphos noted that Stalin was not Russian either, but Georgian. Simon posted the inevitable joke. "**I knew this one was coming.**"

HOW TO BEGIN

PHILOSOPHY, FOR BEGINNERS

"Just watch Destiny and Vaush, that's all the philosophy you'll need."

— Issued to a newcomer who asked what to read. He never spoke again.

IN BRIEF

GRADUATE STUDIES. Simon discloses that he once wrote a Heidegger paper about which he absolutely had no clue what he was talking about, vibed it out, and got a surprisingly good mark. His theory is that the teaching assistant also did not understand Heidegger and thought it sounded about right. Telhar's related finding, on the working-class appeal of continental philosophy: "**great depression-era working class famously were very into heidegger.**"

"Skill issue." — Charlie, on the metaphysics of fact

"With a large enough pipe, you can strike oil anywhere." — My Name

IN BRIEF

A SECOND OPINION. Told that the machines might one day solve some eternal problem for him — "*chop chop*" — a visiting mathematician replied that they aren't *quite* as good as advertised. Informed that the channel's resident sceptic had come round and now has psychosis, he delivered the week's most elegant knife: "**If I were being mean, I would say that it sounds like nothing's changed.**"

THE THIRTY-ELEPHANT MARRIAGE

A dispatch from the international desk

Sisyphos, having asked whether the channel's wealthiest member is ten elephants rich or one elephant rich, supplied the true story underneath the joke without being asked and without a flourish: a woman he knows fled an arranged marriage valued at thirty elephants, moved to Europe, and married his friend.

"is this real what," said chair.

"not jokin."

"forget house poor," said My Name. "**elephant poor.**"

IN BRIEF

THE PSA ARRIVES AFTER THE OFFER. Sisyphos, at close of play on Wednesday: "*How about some meth?*" chair, declining: "*too late now running just on coffee.*" Sisyphos, one message later: "**Don't do meth kids.**"

"life is but lemons, you make lemon juice and cry when the harvest is bad" — Janne

"Get a room you twinks." — Sisyphos, refereeing